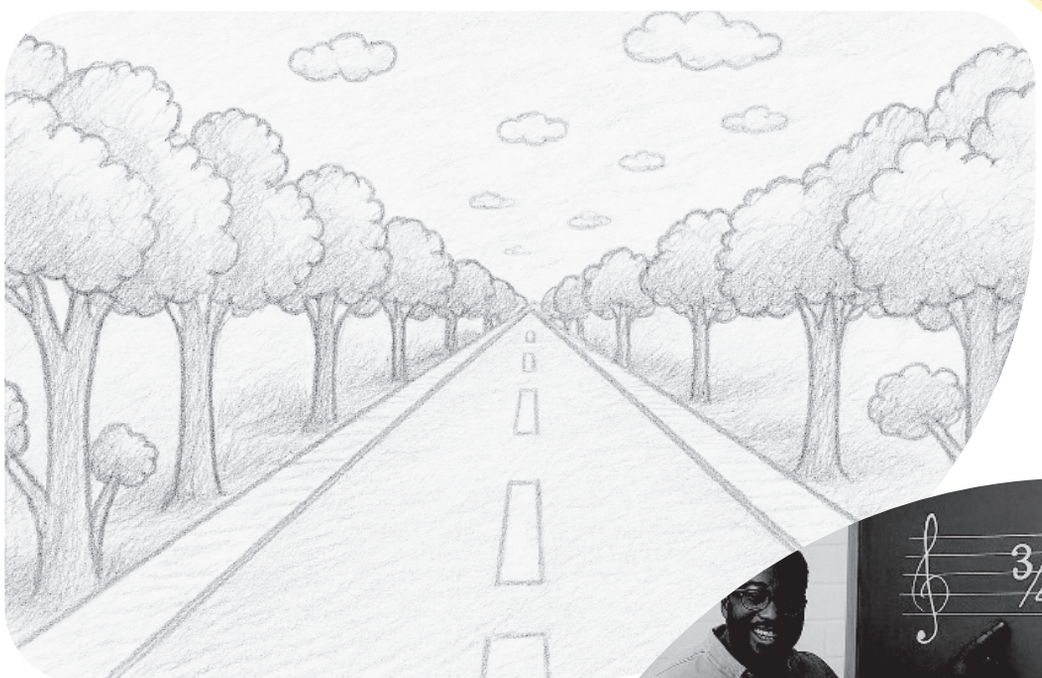
Creative Arts

Fine Arts & Music

P6

Teacher's guide





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Creative Arts:

Fine Arts & Music subjects

Teacher's Book

Primary 6



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FOREWORD

Dear Fine Arts or Music Teacher,

The Rwanda Basic Education Board (REB) is honored to present the *Creative Arts subjects – Fine Arts and Music Teacher's Guide for Primary Six*. This guide is designed to support the effective implementation of the Competence-Based Curriculum (CBC), ensuring consistent and learner-centered teaching practices that align with Rwanda's vision of empowering pupils to reach their full potential, actively participate in society, and pursue meaningful careers.

As Rwanda advances toward building a knowledge-based economy, education plays a pivotal role. Teachers are central to this transformation, guiding learners to connect classroom knowledge with real-life experiences, thus fostering individual growth and national development.

This Teacher's Guide serves as a comprehensive resource for teaching Fine Arts or Music at *Primary Six*. The subject is an integral part of the CBC, aimed at equipping learners with essential knowledge, skills, values, and attitudes necessary for becoming responsible and competent citizens. Through this subject, learners are encouraged to develop problem-solving abilities and contribute positively to their communities.

This guide places special focus on engaging learners in meaningful, activity-based learning experiences; whether individually or collaboratively; where they can explore, discover, and construct knowledge. Unlike traditional approaches where learning is often passive and teacher-centered, the Competence-Based Curriculum promotes active, learner-driven engagement. Teachers encourage pupils to participate in activities that allow them to apply what they learn, to develop key competences, and build values that empower them to positively impact their lives and society.

To support this active learning approach, teachers are encouraged to:

- Plan lessons effectively and prepare relevant materials.
- Facilitate group discussions and collaborative activities.
- Apply active teaching strategies such as inquiry, research, investigations, and both group and individual tasks.
- Create opportunities for learners to develop competences like critical thinking, problem-solving, creativity, innovation, communication, and teamwork.
- Recognize and encourage learners' contributions.

- Guide learners in refining their ideas.
- Promote self, peer, and group assessments using appropriate CBC-based assessment methods.

This Teacher's Guide is divided into three parts:

Part I: Highlights the structure of this book and gives you general methodological guidance.

Part II: Show the sample lesson plans as reference for lesson preparation.

Part III: Provide a detailed of teaching guidance for each concept given in the pupil's book.

I sincerely thank everyone who contributed to the development and refinement of this teacher's guide. Special recognition goes to the REB team who coordinated the entire process, as well as to education development partners, teachers, and all individuals who supported the process from start to the end. Your continued suggestions and feedback are highly valued and will help improve future editions of this textbook.



Dr. MBARUSHIMANA Nelson
Director General, REB

ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

I would like to extend my sincere appreciation to everyone who contributed to the refinement of the *Creative Arts subjects-Fine Arts and Music Teacher's Guide for Primary Six*. This achievement would not have been possible without the active involvement of various education stakeholders.

Special thanks go to the Rwanda Basic Education Board (REB) staff and subject experts for their valuable work on this Teacher's Guide.

I am also deeply grateful to the education development partners whose support was instrumental throughout the process. I acknowledge Teachers, Partners and all stakeholders for their contributions in editing of this guide's development.



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GENERAL INTRODUCTION

1.1 Introduction to the Teacher's Guide

This book is a Teacher's Guide for the *Creative Arts subjects—Fine Arts and Music*—for Primary Six schools in Rwanda. It is to be used to help teachers to implement the competence-based curriculum for the Creative Arts subjects—Fine Arts and Music syllabus.

This is a guide that Fine Arts or Music teachers can refer to when preparing their lessons. Teachers may use the guidance provided, but they should also be creative and consider their own class contexts when preparing their lessons.

This teacher's guide has three main parts:

1. Methodological guidance for the teacher

This section guides the teacher on:

- Developing pupils' competences;
- Integrating cross-cutting issues;
- Teaching learners with special educational needs;
- Ensuring gender inclusion;
- Planning a lesson, using active and techniques for teaching Fine Arts or Music and
- Carrying out appropriate assessment of learning.

2. A sample lesson plan

The sample lesson plan is a guide for teachers in developing their own lesson plans.

3. Unit development

This is the main part of the guide, because it shows the teacher how to teach the content of each unit and lesson.

Each unit begins with the unit title, and the key competences that are taught in the unit. Then the rest of the unit is presented:

- The knowledge, skills, attitudes and values that the pupils should successfully learn in the unit.
- A list of the lessons in the unit, the learning objectives of each lesson, and the number of class periods to be used for each lesson.
- A list of key vocabulary words for the unit.

- The recommended approach to teaching each lesson in the unit, including a list of teaching and learning materials for the lessons.
- Recommended questions and activities for the end of unit assessment. A list of additional activities that can be given to less able pupils (remedial activities), normally-learning pupils (consolidation activities), and advanced pupils (extended activities). These activities could be carried out during class time, or as after-school activities.

1.2 Developing competences

Creative Arts subjects—Fine Arts and Music— follows the approach of the Competence-Based Curriculum (CBC), in which pupils learn actively and collaboratively. In these subjects, pupils are also tested for what they can *do*, not only what they *know*. Pupils gain *knowledge*, *skills* and appropriate *attitudes*, and they demonstrate them in their games and exercises.

In *Creative Arts subjects—Fine Arts and Music—*, pupils also develop **generic** competences which are useful in many situations:

Generic competences	Ways of developing generic competences
Critical thinking	These learning activities require pupils to think strategically and quickly as they engage in Fine Arts or Music career. Pupils must also analyse their own performance and the performance of others, especially in creativity, innovation arts.
Research and problem solving	These activities lead pupils to use what they have already learned as a basis for learning new activities and solving challenges – on the field and in life.
Cooperation and managing relationships	Pupils learn to work well with others on their teams, using the abilities of each person to build strong and positive relationships with each other.
Innovation and creativity	These activities give the pupils opportunities to learn new activities, create a new artwork (in fine Arts) and compose original songs, improvising rhythms.

Communication	In Creative arts, pupils learn to communicate clearly and confidently with each other. In discussing Creative Arts class activities, pupils also gain experience in expressing themselves.
Lifelong learning	The artworks and activities are designed to help pupils practice, encourage curiosity through diverse forms of Fine Arts, and promote exposure and self-expression in music throughout their lives
Professional skills	A Creative Arts teacher can develop professional skills by engaging learners in hands-on activities like drawing, painting, and performing, which build focus, responsibility, and teamwork. Encouraging self-expression promotes creativity and initiative, while using local materials fosters cultural awareness. Inclusive teaching and critical thinking tasks help pupils develop adaptability, collaboration, and problem-solving—key competences for lifelong learning and professionalism.

1.3 Integrating cross-cutting issues in the curriculum

Competency-based learning also addresses specific *cross-cutting issues* into the teaching and learning process. Cross-cutting issues are aspects of life that are relevant to many curriculum subjects, and they should be made part of those subject lessons.

Some cross-cutting issues may seem specific to particular learning areas or subjects, but the teacher needs to address all of them whenever they come up. The pupils should also be encouraged to talk about these cross-cutting issues, in the classroom and outside the classroom, so that they can develop positive attitudes and values related to these issues. The teacher must introduce them at the most appropriate age and grade Level.

Below are examples of how crosscutting issues can be addressed:

Cross-Cutting Issue	Ways of addressing cross cutting issues
Comprehensive Sexuality Education: The Comprehensive Sexuality Education program aims to provide pupils, adolescents, and youth with age-appropriate, culturally and gender-sensitive knowledge, skills, and values. It helps them make responsible decisions about sexual and social relationships. It also supports understanding and expressing feelings, values, and attitudes to promote behaviors that reduce risks and enhance well-being.	• Through Fine Arts, pupils can express personal experiences and values by creating posters, drawings, or collages that promote self-respect, body awareness, gender equality, and healthy relationships. • In Music, pupils can sing songs or listen to lyrics that explore themes such as emotions, consent, and peer pressure, helping them build empathy and confidence.
Genocide Studies: The study of the 1994 Genocide against the Tutsi helps pupils understand it as the worst crime committed against the Tutsi in the1994. It teaches why the genocide happened and emphasizes the importance of preventing such atrocities in the future. The story of recovery and national unity in Rwanda serves as a foundation for rebuilding the nation. Educating pupils on fighting genocide denial and its ideology is crucial. This knowledge equips learners to help prevent future genocides.	• Teachers use simple methods to teach primary pupils about the 1994 genocide against the Tutsi, starting by asking what they know about the 1994 genocide against the Tutsi. • In primary level, pupils discuss 1994 genocide against the Tutsi in pairs or groups, share their ideas, and ask questions. • Teachers clearly explain what the 1994 genocide against the Tutsi is, why it happened in 1994, and why it must never happen again. • Lessons include Rwanda's recovery, national unity, and the importance of peace, with possible visits to 1994 genocide against the Tutsi memorial sites for older pupils.

Environment and Sustainability: Integration of studies around the Environment, climate Change and Sustainability in the curriculum make pupils understand the need to protect the environment.	• Teachers should use real-life examples and pupils' experiences to explain environmental issues like soil erosion, effects of tree cutting and flooding, while encouraging responsible waste disposal and care during practical activities.
Financial Education: The integration of Financial Education into the curriculum is to teach young pupils the use of money; teach them to develop the culture of saving and how to use money responsibly.	• Teachers should guide pupils to discuss the importance of money, saving through methods like saving boxes or bank accounts, and spending wisely on essential needs. Pupils should also learn to use materials and tools carefully to make them last longer and avoid unnecessary replacements.
Gender: At school, gender roles should be understood as roles that complement each other in a family, in a community or the nation.	• Teachers should address gender issue through assigning leading roles in groups to both girls and boys; provide equal participation in the lesson to avoid any gender stereotype in the learning process. • Give pupils time to talk about different gender roles they know from their homes and how they complement each other. Let pupils discuss why these roles are beneficial for everyone.
Inclusive Education: Inclusion is based on the right of all pupils to a quality and equitable education that meets their basic learning needs and understands the diversity of backgrounds and abilities as a learning opportunity.	• Teachers should identify pupils with special needs and use adapted teaching and learning resources when available while conducting a lesson. • Teachers must encourage inclusive participation and foster peer support for learners with disabilities.

Peace and Values Education: Peace and Values Education (PVE) is the education that promotes social cohesion, and positive values, including the culture of peace personal responsibility, empathy, critical thinking to build a more peaceful society.	• Through a given lesson, a teacher should set a learning objective which address positive attitudes and values, e.g. encourage pupils to discuss positively, listen to each other's ideas, take turns and be able to come up with meaning full positive ideas. • The teacher leads pupils to discuss on the meaning peace and why it is important to have peace at home, at school and in the community. • Encourage pupils to respect each other and to create good peaceful and friendly relations
Standardization Culture: Standardization Culture is about introducing a positive culture around the classroom that promotes respect of instructions, classroom rules; good health, cleanliness, self-development self-respect; dignity and the respect of other people and other people's culture.	• Lessons that involve making things should emphasize quality work and using the right materials properly. • Engaging pupils with practical activities and word problems helps them to understand their role and recognize how a culture of standardization contributes to health, the economy, industry, and overall well-being.
Impact of Social Media: Teaching the impact of social media fosters digital literacy, creativity, and collaboration while providing access to diverse learning resources. It promotes critical thinking and responsible online behavior. However, balanced use is essential to avoid distractions and mental health issues. This prepares pupils for effective digital engagement in their academic and social lives.	• To make digital learning safe, and engaging, the activities should be interactive, visual, and story-based, while being culturally relevant and age-appropriate. • Digital safety can be taught through Child Online Protection clubs; edutainment and interactive multimedia textbooks; storytelling and games. Edutainment makes learning engaging and practical. Role-playing and puzzles help pupils practice safe internet habits and handle online risks. • To set clear, age-appropriate rules for internet use, start by having open conversations about which websites and apps they want to use and explain the importance of safety.

Disaster Risk Reduction and Management: It builds essential awareness and skills for disaster preparedness. This helps pupils from being victims and teaches them the culture of staying safe. It nurtures critical thinking, problem-solving and social responsibility, empowering pupils as agents of change for sustainable development. This prepares future generations to adapt effectively to the problems brought by climate change.	• Engaging pupils in projects to identify any local disasters that might have happened and to plan how to avoid such disasters in future. • Using storytelling and role-playing based on community to present to the class what they can in case the disaster occurs again • Forming disaster management clubs that promote peer learning and community outreach.

1.4 Attention to pupils' special educational needs in teaching and learning

In teaching Fine Arts and/or Music, it is important to pay close attention to pupils' special educational needs. Learners with disabilities are often excluded from practical activities, as they may only observe rather than participate. However, Fine Arts and Music can be highly beneficial for students with physical, mental, or emotional disabilities. Teachers should focus on what each pupil can do and adapt the tasks or instruments to match their abilities. The level of difficulty should be adjusted to ensure inclusion, creativity, and expression. All learners should be treated with respect and encouraged to participate actively in a supportive and natural environment.

For example:

- Adjust art or music activities to match pupils' physical or cognitive abilities.
- Modify the rules of group in music games or art tasks so that all pupils can participate comfortably.
- Provide adapted instruments or tools that are easier to handle (e.g., larger paintbrushes, lightweight drums, colour-coded keys).
- Reduce the duration of the activity to avoid fatigue or frustration.
- Offer clear, step-by-step instructions using simple language, and demonstrate tasks visually when possible.
- Allow extra time for pupils who need more support or a slower pace.
- Encourage peer support and cooperative work to build inclusion and confidence.

- Celebrate each learner's progress and creativity, not just performance or precision.

These inclusive strategies help ensure that every pupil, regardless of ability, can express themselves artistically, enjoy learning, and feel valued in the Fine Arts or Music classroom.

The teacher should work closely with the school's Special Educational Needs (SEN) coordinator to ensure that pupils with specific disabilities are fully supported and able to participate meaningfully in Fine Arts and Music lessons. Adapting instruction to meet individual needs fosters inclusion and improves learning outcomes for all.

Some inclusive strategies include:

- **Visual impairments:**

Pair the pupil with a supportive partner. Simplify instructions and provide spoken cues for activities or musical patterns. Use tactile materials (e.g., textured art tools or raised-note music sheets) and reduce the pace of the activity to allow better engagement.

- **Hearing impairments**

Use clear, consistent visual cues, gestures, and body language. Demonstrate activities whenever possible. Pair the pupil with a peer who can assist with communication or interpretation. Written instructions and visual demonstrations are essential.

- **Physical disabilities:**

Modify tools or instruments for accessibility (e.g., adapted grips or mounted drums). Adjust the setup of the classroom or studio space to ensure wheelchair access. Reduce movement-based tasks or allow seated participation in musical and artistic performances.

- **Developmental (mental) disabilities:**

Provide clear and simple instructions, using visual aids when possible. Repeat directions and allow time for the pupil to observe, imitate, and learn at their own pace. Use structured routines and positive reinforcement to build confidence and engagement.

These strategies ensure that Fine Arts and Music education is inclusive, adaptive, and empowering giving every pupil the opportunity to express themselves creatively and feel a sense of achievement.

1.5 Gender inclusion

Due to common stereotypes in Creative Arts, especially in Fine Arts and Music, girls may sometimes feel excluded or less confident in expressing themselves. The teacher should actively encourage gender inclusion in the following ways:

- Encourage girls to participate fully in all artistic and musical activities and praise their efforts and creativity.
- Give girls equal opportunities to lead group projects, conduct musical pieces, or organize exhibitions and performances.
- Ensure equal access to materials, instruments, and time for practice or presentation.
- Provide additional support or encouragement when needed to help build confidence.
- Respect and value girls' ideas and expressions in both visual art and music.
- Avoid comments or attitudes that suggest certain art or music skills are more suited to boys.
- Engage parents to support and motivate their daughters in exploring and developing their talents in Creative Arts.

1.6 Using the active learning approach to teach a Fine Arts and/ or a Music lesson

Pupils in the classroom learn in different ways, known as learning styles:

- **Active or reflective:** some pupils learn best by creating or performing (active), while others learn by observing and thinking about the process (reflective).
- **Sensing or intuitive:** some prefer learning specific techniques or steps (sensing), while others enjoy exploring concepts or themes in art or music (intuitive).
- **Visual or verbal:** some pupils understand better through images, colors, and demonstrations (visual), while others respond well to verbal instructions or discussions (verbal).
- **Sequential or global:** some pupils prefer step-by-step instruction (sequential), while others understand better after seeing the complete artwork or performance concept (global).

In Fine Arts or Music subjects, the best way to engage most learners is through active learning. Pupils learn better when they are involved in hands-on activities such as:

- Creating visual art using various materials and techniques.
- Practicing musical skills like singing, clapping rhythms, or playing instruments.
- Working together on group projects or performances.
- Reflecting on their work and thinking about how to improve it.

The teacher supports active learning by:

- Demonstrating techniques and guiding learners through examples.
- Giving both group and individual creative tasks.
- Encouraging problem-solving, self-expression, and collaboration.

- Providing feedback and support throughout the learning process.

The Competence-Based Curriculum encourages pupils to learn by doing. In Creative Arts, this means:

- Learning through real artistic and musical experiences.
- Practicing in relevant settings such as classrooms, school performances, or community exhibitions.
- Applying what they learn to real-life contexts for communication, cultural expression, enjoyment, and personal growth.

1.7 Principles of teaching Fine Arts and/or Music subject

Learner-centered approach by focusing on active participation and engagement of all learners through practical, hands-on experiences in art and music-making.

Competence-based learning by developing not just knowledge but *skills, attitudes, and values,* especially creativity, collaboration, communication, and critical thinking.

Inclusiveness and equity by adapting teaching to include all pupils regardless of ability, gender, or background. Ensure equal access to materials, roles, and participation.

Cultural Relevance by using Rwandan culture, music, stories, and art forms to promote national identity and cultural pride. Encourage the use of local materials.

Integration of Learning Styles by catering to different learning styles: visual, auditory, kinesthetic, reflective, etc., using diverse teaching methods like demonstration, storytelling, songs, and drawing.

Learning by Doing (active learning) by emphasizing creativity through practice: drawing, painting, modeling, singing, rhythm, composing, and performing.

Collaborative learning by encouraging teamwork through group projects, performances, and art making, building interpersonal and professional skills.

Use of Continuous Assessment by assessing pupils through observation, performance tasks, portfolios, and constructive feedback rather than only written exams.

Developmentally appropriate teaching by tailoring content and activities to the age and level of pupils, ensuring they are stimulating, manageable, and relevant.

Encouraging self-expression and confidence by allow pupils to express their feelings, thoughts, and ideas through art and music, helping build self-esteem and communication skills.

These principles support the holistic development of Rwandan primary school pupils and prepare them for lifelong learning, creativity, and social participation.

A Fine Arts or music lesson should be planned of time, so that the content of the lesson is clear, the activities are appropriate to the ages of the pupils, the teaching methods include behaviour management, and the teacher is confident in giving the lesson.

A Fine Arts or Music lesson should include these steps:

***Before the lesson*:**

The teacher should prepare the classroom or studio, ensuring that the space is suitable for the day's artistic or musical activity. Any necessary materials or instruments—such as paints, brushes, drawing tools, sheet music, or musical instruments—should be organized and readily available. Visual aids or audio equipment should also be set up in advance to support the lesson effectively.

Starting the lesson:

The teacher should start on time, even if some pupils are late. S/he should begin by welcoming the pupils and briefly outlining the objectives of the day's Fine Arts or Music lesson. This may include introducing a new artistic technique (if it is fine art subject), or musical concept, or piece to study (if it is music subject). The teacher should engage students' interest with a short demonstration, listening activity, or discussion about the theme or historical context of the lesson. Clear instructions should be given, and expectations for behaviour, creativity, and participation should be reinforced.

During the lesson:

Firstly, the teacher checks on the pupils' readiness and ensures that all necessary materials or instruments are in place. A brief review or connection to the previous lesson may be done to re-engage the pupils. The teacher then introduces the day's art or music activity in an engaging way to spark curiosity and interest.

Secondly, warm-up activities are conducted—such as vocal exercises, breathing techniques, finger stretches for musicians, or quick sketching and color mixing exercises for artists—to prepare students for the main task.

The main activity takes up most of the 40-minute lesson time. This could include learning a new song, practicing a musical instrument, creating a drawing or painting, or working on a collaborative project. The teacher should keep explanations clear and concise, demonstrating techniques when needed, or asking a knowledgeable student to demonstrate for the class. Throughout the activity, the teacher offers guidance, encouragement, and corrections to help students stay engaged and improve their skills.

Ending the lesson:

The closing discussion encourages pupils to reflect on their artistic or musical experience—what they created, performed, or learned—and to make connections to previous lessons or personal experiences. They should be guided to think about how the skills or ideas from today's lesson could be applied in future projects or performances.

After the discussion, all materials or instruments used during the lesson should be cleaned (if necessary), properly stored, and organized for future use. Pupils can be assigned roles to help with this process to encourage responsibility and care for the tools and workspace.

If any materials, tools, or instruments are found to be damaged or in poor condition, the teacher should report this to the Headteacher so repairs or replacements can be arranged.

1.8 Assessment

In Fine Arts or Music, the teacher assesses not only pupils' technical abilities, but also their *creativity, emotional expression*, and *collaborative skills*. Three key types of student assessment are important in these subjects:

Diagnostic assessment: Before beginning a lesson or unit, the teacher assesses students' prior knowledge and basic skills—such as drawing techniques, familiarity with musical notation, rhythm, or instrument handling. This helps the teacher identify students who may need additional guidance or support.

Formative assessment: During the lesson, the teacher continuously observes and gives feedback on pupils' participation, effort, and progress. In Fine Arts or Music, this includes evaluating skill development, creativity, engagement, cooperation in group work (like ensemble playing or collaborative art), and growing confidence.

Summative assessment: At the end of a unit, or term, pupils are assessed on specific learning outcomes. In Music, this could include performance skills, accuracy in pitch or rhythm, or knowledge of musical theory. In Fine Arts, it might include composition, use of materials, technique mastery, and originality. Reflection journals, portfolios, or performances may also be used as part of the summative evaluation.

Briefly, assessment in Fine Arts or Music at the primary level helps track the development of key skills such as creativity, self-expression, coordination, listening, and fine motor skills. It also supports emotional growth, builds self-confidence, and encourages teamwork and communication. Through regular feedback, pupils learn to reflect on their progress, take pride in their work, and develop a deeper appreciation for the arts.

SAMPLE LESSON PLAN IN A CBC TEXTBOOK

1.1 The structure of the units in Pupil's Book

In a Competence-Based Curriculum, the unit's structure focuses on specific skills, knowledge, values and the right attitudes which are described in the learning outcomes. Each unit includes a tittle; introductory part; study content; performance criteria and the context in which the acquired skill is applied

1.2 Unit title

A statement of the competencies covered in the unit often expressed as learning outcomes.

1. **Unit description:** Provides a more detailed overview of the unit's application in the workplace or context including related competencies.
2. **Activity:** Key activities learners are able to do or perform to be considered as competent.
3. **Performance Criteria:** Standards of Performance needed to demonstrate competency. How the content of a unit is performed in order to provide the basis for assessment.
4. **Range of Variables** defines the context, scope or resources under which the performance criteria can apply.
5. **Evidence Guide:** Guidance on assessing the unit and types of evidence needed to demonstrate the Competency.
6. **Application:** describes how the unit is applied in real life.

1.3 Sample lesson plan template

The teacher's guide provides more than one lesson plan taking into consideration the type of lesson in the subject using the CBC format.

Teaching requires good preparation to be effective. This is the only way that learning can be enhanced and assured. The teacher will find his/her work easier if s/he goes to class well prepared with the lesson content organized in logical manner. Even the experienced Music teacher needs a lesson plan to use the lesson time effectively. Below is a sample of a lesson plan.

PART I: FINE ARTS

SAMPLE LESSON PLAN (Fine Arts)

School name ..... **Academic year:** .....

Teachers' Name.....

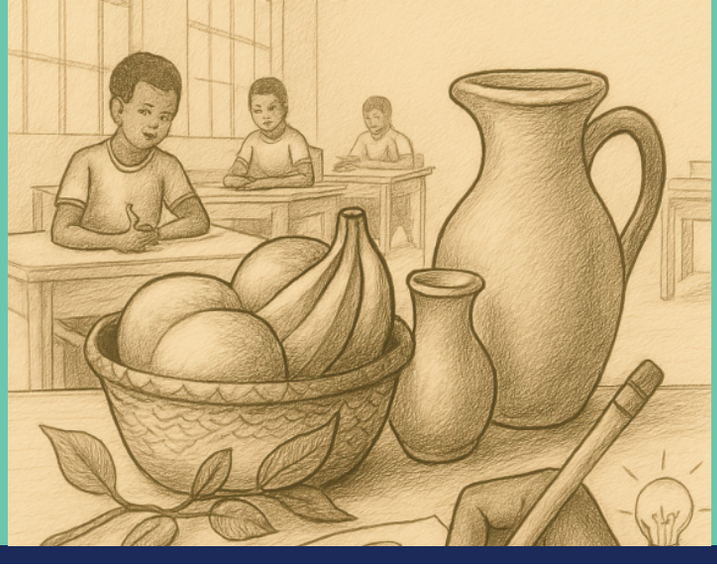
Term	Date	Subject	Class	Unit N°	Lesson N°	Duration	Class size
1	...	Creative Arts - Fine Arts	P6	1	1 of 3	40 min	50
Types of special educational needs and the number of pupils				Teacher will provide tactile examples (cardboard shapes) for visually impaired pupils to feel balance. For others, may provide pre-drawn shapes to arrange.			
Unit title		**Introduction to composition arrangement**					
Key unit competence		Pupils will be able to apply balance, perspective, and proportion in drawing and painting artworks.					
Title of the Lesson		Applying balance in a drawing					
Instructional objective		By the end of the lesson, pupils will be able to create a simple drawing demonstrating either symmetrical or asymmetrical balance.					
Plan for this class (location: in/ outside)		The lesson is delivered in the classroom.					
Teaching and learning resources		**Visual aids:** Images showing clear symmetry (butterflies, faces, buildings) and asymmetry. **For pupils:** Drawing paper, pencils, rulers, erasers. **For support:** Butterfly wing templates, light box/window for tracing, pre-cut cardboard shapes. **For demonstration:** Board or large chart paper.					
References		Creative Arts/ Fine Arts syllabus.					

Timing for each step	Description of teaching and learning activity		Competence and cross-cutting issues to be addressed
	Teacher's activities	**Pupil's activities**	
Introduction: 5 min	Teacher begins with the hook question: • You are to draw a butterfly and you want it to look balanced on paper. Why is balance important in art? Accepts all answers, then guides towards the key concept: "Balance creates visual harmony and stability. It makes art feel 'right' to our eyes."	Pupils think, pair, share their ideas with a partner.	**Critical thinking:** Generating hypotheses about art principles. **Communication:** Expressing ideas clearly. Inclusion: Verbal responses are prioritized.
Lesson development: 25 min	**Activity 1** **Direct instruction (10 min):** Teacher defines Balance (visual equilibrium), Symmetry (mirror-image), and Asymmetry (different but equal weight). Uses strong visual examples. Draws a vertical "axis" line on the board to demonstrate.	Pupils take notes in their sketchbooks (key terms and definitions).	**Critical thinking:** Analyzing, classifying, and problem-solving. **Differentiation:** Struggling learners use templates/tracing. Advanced learners are challenged to explain why their solution works. **Gender balance**: Teacher ensures all pupils are called on during guided practice.
	Activity 2 **Guided practice (10 min):** Teacher conducts "Task 1": Shows three images (Symmetrical, Asymmetrical, Symmetrical). For each, asks: "Raise your hand if you think this is symmetrical? Asymmetrical? How has the artist achieved balance here?"	Pupils actively participate by identifying and justifying their choices.	
	Activity 3 **Independent practice (5 min):** Teacher: introduces "Task 2": The fruit drawing. "Complete this drawing to make it balanced. Is your solution symmetrical or asymmetrical? Label it."	Pupils work individually to solve the balance problem.	

Conclusion: 5 min	Teacher facilitates a quick "Gallery Walk" where pupils view each other's Task 2 solutions. Leads a brief discussion: • Which type of balance feels more stable? Which feels more interesting? Then, assigns the exit ticket: • On a scrap paper, quickly sketch one symmetrical object and one asymmetrical object. Label them.	Pupils participate in the gallery walk, discuss, complete the exit ticket, and hand it in.	**Cooperation:** Respectful discussion during gallery walk.
Self-evaluation	• Did the exit tickets show that pupils could define and identify the two types of balance? • Was the guided practice (Task 1) effective? • Which pupils struggled with Task 2? How can I support them next lesson?		

CONTENT MAP FOR FINE ART

No	Unit titles	Proposed key unit competences	Proposed periods per unit
1	USING COLOUR IN ART	Pupils will be able to use colour and paint different pictures from observation and imagination.	8
2	PATTERN DESIGNS	Pupils will be able to create various motif on surfaces.	7
3	LETTER STYLES	Pupils will be able to identify Serif and Sans Serif letters, pick the best style and design interesting posters using different tools of art.	13
4	COLLAGE ARTS	Pupils will be able to make collage using available resources.	5
TOTAL			**33**



Unit 1

INTRODUCTION TO COMPOSITION ARRANGEMENT

1.1 Key unit competence

Pupils will be able to apply balance, perspective, and proportion in drawing and painting artworks.

1.2 Learning objectives

At the end of this unit, a pupil should be able to:

Knowledge and understanding

- Recognize how shapes can be combined to draw real-life objects.
- Understand how artists create depth, balance, and 3D effects in their work.

Skills

- Arrange objects in a well-composed artwork with a clear focal point.
- Use overlapping and size variation to show distance.
- Apply cross-hatching and stippling techniques for shading and texture.

Attitudes and values

- Appreciate how artists organize and balance their compositions.
- Practice patience and careful observation when drawing.
- Respect different artistic styles and the efforts of fellow artists.

1.3 Prerequisites

To effectively draw still life by applying art principles, pupils need to have foundational knowledge of the basic elements of art such as line, shape, form, color, texture, and value. They should be familiar with what still life is and how to observe and represent real-life objects. Pupils must also possess basic drawing and shading skills, including the ability to draw geometric forms, apply light and shadow, and arrange objects spatially. In addition to technical skills, positive attitudes such as curiosity, patience, confidence, and a willingness to learn and observe carefully are essential. Pupils should uphold values such as creativity, discipline, appreciation for

beauty, and respect for their own and others' artistic work, which together support meaningful and expressive still life drawing.

1.4 Guidance on introductory activities

Introductory activity

Teacher should begin with engaging warm-up exercises designed to:

- Assess prior knowledge from P5 by having pupils recall/demonstrate basic drawing skills.
- Build confidence through simple, achievable shape-drawing tasks.

Recommended approaches:

- Start with fundamental shapes to establish routines and comfort.
- Use familiar objects (home materials like basket, saucepan, jerrycan, etc...) for freehand practice that feels accessible.

Purpose:

These starter activities allow teachers to:

- Identify individual skill levels (strengths/needs).
- Create an inclusive foundation for all Pupils, including those needing additional support.

1.5 List of lessons

N°	Lesson	Objectives	N° of Periods
1	Balance in a drawing	• Identify principles of art. • Apply balance (symmetry/asymmetry) in a drawing.	3
2	Perspective in art	• Apply one-point perspective to create a realistic street scene. • Use shading technique to show form and texture in drawings.	2
3	proportion in art	Define proportion and explain its importance in making drawings look realistic. • Apply composition rules to arrange objects in a still-life drawing. • Use overlapping and size variation to create depth in artwork.	2
4	End of unit 1 assessment		1

Lesson 1: Balance in art

a. Lesson objectives

By the end of this lesson, pupils will be able to:

- Define balance in art.
- Identify symmetrical and asymmetrical balance in artworks.
- Apply shading technique to an artwork.

b. Teaching and Learning materials

- Drawing paper and pencils
- Butterfly wing templates (for symmetry practice)
- Visual aids:
  - Symmetrical examples (butterflies, faces, geometric designs)
  - Asymmetrical examples (still-life drawings, landscapes)
- Rulers (to draw axes for balance analysis)
- Light box/ window (for tracing symmetry)

c. Teaching and Learning methodology

1. Warm-up: Discussion

Question 1: *"You are to draw a butterfly and you want it to look balanced on paper. Tell us why you think it is important to use balance in art."*

Key answer: Balance is used to create visual harmony and stability.

Question 2: *"Why do butterfly wings look realistic in drawings?"*

Guided answer:

- Their **symmetrical balance** imitates nature.

2. Direct instruction

Principles of art: Balance and symmetry

- Balance= Visual equilibrium (no side feels "heavier").
- Symmetry= Mirror-image balance (like butterfly wings).
- Asymmetry= Different objects balancing (e.g., large tree on one side, small house on the other).

Demonstration: Types of balance

To understand balance, one should imagine each artwork/picture as having a middle line called **"axis,"** dividing the artwork/ picture into two equal parts.

1. **Symmetrical balance:** Both sides mirror each other (like an orange cut into half or two butterfly's wings).



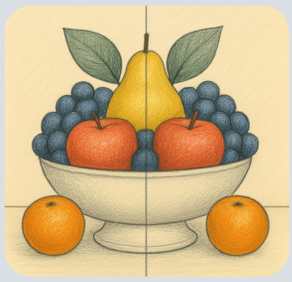
2. **Asymmetrical balance:** Different objects balance each other



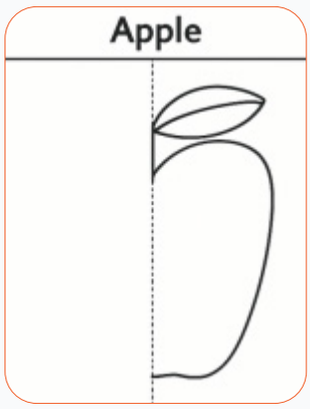
3. Learning activity

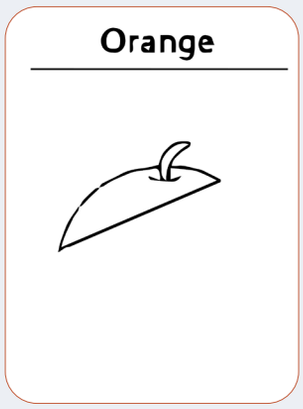
Application activity 1.1

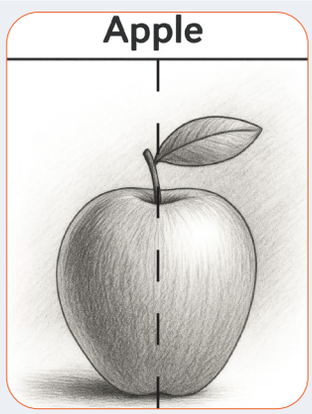
1. Ask pupils to observe the drawing provided and name the type of balance used. Let them how explain how the balance has been achieved.

1		***Symmetrical balance***
2		***Asymmetrical balance***
3		***Symmetrical balance***

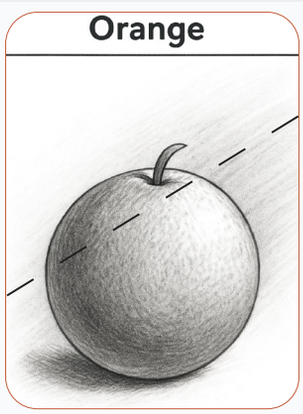
2. **Task 2:** Complete the following drawing and name the type of balance on each fruit.







This line shows symmetrical balance



This line shows asymmetrical balance

Discussion:

- Which feels more stable?

Possible answers: Symetrical balance feels more stable because all the sides have the same visual weight.

5. Wrap-up

Exit ticket:

- Sketch one object with **symmetry** and one with **asymmetry**. Label each.

Assessment rubric

Criteria	Emerging	Proficient	Advanced
Balance Identification	Labels 1 type correctly	Labels 2 types correctly	Explains *why* balance works
Shading application	Basic even shading	Uses value to show depth	Creates 3D realism
Composition	Unbalanced	Balanced but static	Dynamic + intentional

Teacher notes

- ***Support:*** Provide pre-drawn axes or tracing paper for symmetry.
- ***Extension:*** Introduce radial balance (mandalas, sunbursts).

- ***Cross-curricular:***
  - ***Science:*** Butterfly wing anatomy.
  - ***Math:*** Measuring symmetrical proportions.

Example answers for activities:

- ***Butterfly wings:*** "They are symmetrical, and shading makes them look 3D."
- ***Fruit balance:*** "A big apple on the left balances 3 small grapes on the right (asymmetrical)."

Lesson 2: Perspective in art

a. Learning objective

By the end of the lesson, Pupils should be able to:

- Define and identify the horizon line and vanishing point in perspective drawing.
- Apply one-point perspective to create a realistic street scene.
- Use shading techniques (hatching) to show form and texture in drawings.

b. Teaching and learning resources

- Drawing paper or draw books
- Pencils of different grades
- Erasers and sharpeners
- Rulers (for creating perspective lines)
- Charcoal or coloured pencils for texture and shading

c. Prerequisites

Pupils should be able to identify and draw basic shapes and forms (e.g., circles, cylinders, cubes) and have prior experience with simple still life objects. They should also demonstrate basic observation skills and an understanding of space proportion.

d. Teaching and learning methodology

1. Introduction

Engage Pupils with questions:

Look at your hand. Make a little square with your fingers. 📸

- See your friend? Put them in your square!
- Are they big in the square? Yes! 👧➡️🟩

- Now tell your friend to walk back... back... back...

Look in your square again!

- Oh! Now they are small! 👧➡️⬜
- Why? Because they are far! The square didn't change but your friend got tinier inside it! 👀

Explain key concepts:

- Perspective helps drawings look realistic by showing depth (near vs. far).
- Two main rules: horizon line (eye level) and vanishing point (where lines meet).

Demonstration:

- Draw a simple road with trees on the board using one-point perspective.

2. Teaching key concepts

A. Horizon line

- ***Definition:*** Where the sky and ground seem to meet (also at eye level).
- ***Activity:*** Ask pupils to look outside (if possible) or at a picture to identify the horizon.

B. Vanishing point

- ***Definition:*** The point where parallel lines (e.g., road edges) meet in the distance.
- ***Drawing exercise:*** Have Pupils practice drawing a straight road with one vanishing point.

C. Form in art (Shading and texture)

- ***Shading (hatching):***
  - Show how overlapping lines create shadows.
  - Demonstrate on a circle (orange) to show roundness.
- ***Texture:***
  - Compare smooth (pineapple skin) vs. rough (tomato skin).

3. Application activity

A. One-Point perspective street scene

- Pupils draw a street with:
  - A clear horizon line and vanishing point.

- ***Optional:*** Add details like trees.

B. Shading and texture practice

- ***Circle:*** Use hatching to show shadows and roundness.
- ***Cube:*** Use rough, uneven lines to show texture.

Teacher's tip:

- Walk around to assist Pupils struggling with perspective lines or shading.

4. Review and conclusion

Recap questions:

- What happens to objects as they move toward the vanishing point?
- How does shading make a drawing look more real?

Showcase work:

- Let 2-3 pupils share their drawings and explain their techniques.

Homework/ Extension:

- Draw a bedroom using one-point perspective.

e. Assessment

Check for:

- Correct use of horizon line and vanishing point.
- Effective shading/ texture in the orange and stone wall.
- Neatness and attention to detail.

Materials needed:

- Pencils, erasers, rulers, drawing paper.
- Example images of streets and textured objects.

Adaptations:

- ***Struggling pupils:*** Provide pre-drawn horizon/vanishing point guidelines.
- ***Advanced pupils:*** Challenge them with two-point perspective (e.g., corner view of a building).

Lesson 3: Proportion in art

a. Learning objective

By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

- Define proportion and explain its importance in making drawings look realistic.

- Apply composition rules to arrange objects in a still-life drawing.

b. Teaching and learning materials

- Pencils, erasers, paper, real objects (e.g., bottles, books).
- Visual examples (correct vs. incorrect proportion)

c. Prerequisites

Pupils should be able to **identify and draw lines, shapes, and familiar objects from observation or memory**.

d. Teaching and learning methodology

1. Introduction

Engage pupils with a visual comparison:

- Show two images (one with correct proportion, one without).





- ***Ask:*** "Which phone would be easier to carry in your pocket, and why?"

Example: Mobile phones:

Ever wonder why phones are designed small and slim? So they can:

- Fit in your pocket or hand.
- Be easy to carry and use anywhere.
- Stay lightweight yet powerful.

This applies to everything around us!

- ***Books:*** A thin notebook slides into bags easily.
- ***Chairs:*** Small stools fit under tables neatly.
- ***Cups:*** A short cup fits in the cupboard better than a tall one.

Explain key concept:

- ***Proportion*= Drawing objects in the right sizes compared to another.

What is proportion?

- Proportion is about size relationships how big, small, long, or wide something

is compared to another. It helps things fit and function well in our daily lives.

2. Teaching key concepts

- Explain different examples of proportions shown in a pupil's book and sketch a simple scene to show proportion.

3. Application activity

- Draw a child stand outside the house

4. Review and conclusion

- ***Recap questions:*** You can ask pupils: "Can you spot other well proportioned things in your classroom or at home?"
- ***Peer feedback:*** Pupils pair up to compare drawings and give one compliment.

Homework/ Extension:

- Draw a still-life of breakfast items (plate, spoon, cup) using proportion rules.

e. Assessment

Check for:

- Correct use of proportion (size variation).
- Effective overlapping and composition.
- Neatness and effort.

1.6 End of unit 1 assessment



End of unit assessment

Part 1: Knowledge

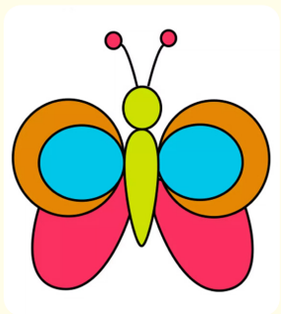
1. Key concepts

i. Define:

- Horizon line: **The horizon line is the line where the sky and the ground seem to meet.**
- Vanishing point: **The vanishing point is the place far away where straight lines seem to meet.**

2. Balance in art

i. Circle the type of balance shown:
   - **Symmetrical** (mirrored)/ **Asymmetrical** (different but balanced)



3. Proportion

- If a cow is really bigger than a goat, why would an artist sometimes draw the goat to look bigger than the cow in a picture?

  Possible answer: Because the goat is closer to us!

Part 2: Skills

4. Perspective drawing

- Task: Draw a road using one-point perspective:
  - Include horizon line and vanishing point.



Part 3: Attitudes and values

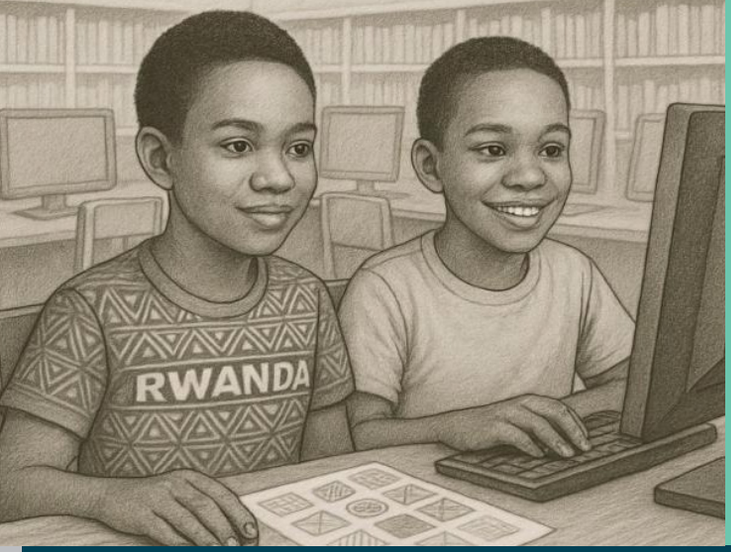
5. Reflection

- Was using one point perspective while drawing easy?



Talent watch!

The teacher should pay attention to note pupils with special skill in drawing so that the talent can be nurtured. This can be done by enrolling them to the school clubs responsible for art.



Unit 2

DIGITAL PATTERN DESIGN

2.1 Key unit competence

Pupils will be able to design and produce digital patterns.

2.2 Learning objectives

At the end of this unit, a pupil should be able to:

Knowledge and understanding

- Understand how to use computer tools like Microsoft Paint® to create designs.
- Recognize the difference between motifs (single designs) and patterns (repeated designs).
- Explore geometric, cultural, and nature-inspired patterns.
- Learn about traditional art like Imigongo and its importance in preserving culture.

Skills

- Use Microsoft Paint® to create digital motifs and repeat patterns.
- Design full-drop and half-drop repeat patterns.
- Apply digital tools to develop clean and creative textile designs.

Attitudes and values

- Appreciate how artists organize and balance objects in their work.
- Practice patience and careful observation when drawing from real life.
- Respect different artistic styles and the efforts of others.

2.3 Prerequisites

Pupils should already have a basic understanding of geometric shapes and balance. They need attitudes such as openness to experiment nature inspired and cultural designs, patience for detailed work, and receptiveness to feedback. Finally, they should respect cultural traditions, attribute sources responsibly, and value creativity and collaboration in the digital design process.

2.4 Guidance on introductory activity

The teacher begins with:

1. Preparing 2–3 visuals (printed or projected): single motifs and full-drop or half-drop patterns.
2. Ask pupils what they notice *"What is this? Where might you see it?"*
3. In pairs, have them predict whether each image is a motif or pattern and which repeat type it is.
4. Share as a class, writing answers on the board.
5. Confirm the correct terms:
    - Single = Motif
    - Repeated = Pattern
    - Straight Grid = Full-Drop
    - Staggered Grid = Half-Drop
    - Possible uses (textiles, adverts, Imigongo art)
6. Encourage pupils to suggest other examples they've seen.

Pupils learn:

- The meanings of motif, pattern, full-drop, and half-drop
- Real-world applications of patterns, including cultural ones
- The confidence to suggest ideas, even when unsure

2.5 List of lessons

N°	Lesson title	Learning objectives	Number of periods
1	Digital motif design	• Understand how digital tools can create and modify motifs. • Design a simple motif by hand and predict how to recreate it digitally.	3
2	Digital patterns design	• Use Microsoft Paint® tools (shapes, fill, copy-paste) to create a repeating pattern. • Save and export digital artwork properly.	3
3	End of unit 2 assessment		1

Lesson 1: Digital motif design

a. Learning objective

By the end of the lesson, Pupils should be able to:

- Identify motifs in everyday objects and nature.
- Understand how digital tools can create and modify motifs.
- Design a simple motif by hand and predict how to recreate it digitally.

b. Teaching and learning resources

- Paper, pencils, erasers.
- Digital devices (if available) with Paint/Word.
- Printed images of patterns (optional).

Adaptations:

- Struggling Pupils: Provide stencils or tracing paper for motifs.

c. Prerequisites

Pupils should have a basic understanding of shapes, lines, and colors, as well as prior experience with hand-drawing simple designs. An interest in exploring patterns in everyday surroundings and a willingness to experiment with both hand-drawn and digital art forms are essential. Additionally, pupils should recognize the importance of motifs in various art forms and appreciate cultural motifs and their applications.

d. Teaching and learning methodology

1. Introduction

Engage pupils with observation:

- Find patterns in your uniforms, classroom walls, and nature.
- Ask: "What shapes or lines repeat in these patterns?"

  Possible answers: Triangles, rectangles, squares, etc...

Explain key concept:

- A motif is a single, repeating design element (e.g., a star, leaf, or circle).
- Digital motifs use software (Paint, Word) to copy, resize, and arrange motifs into patterns.

Demonstration:

- Display a hand-drawn motif and show how it can be duplicated digitally.

2. Teaching key concepts

A. Types of digital motifs

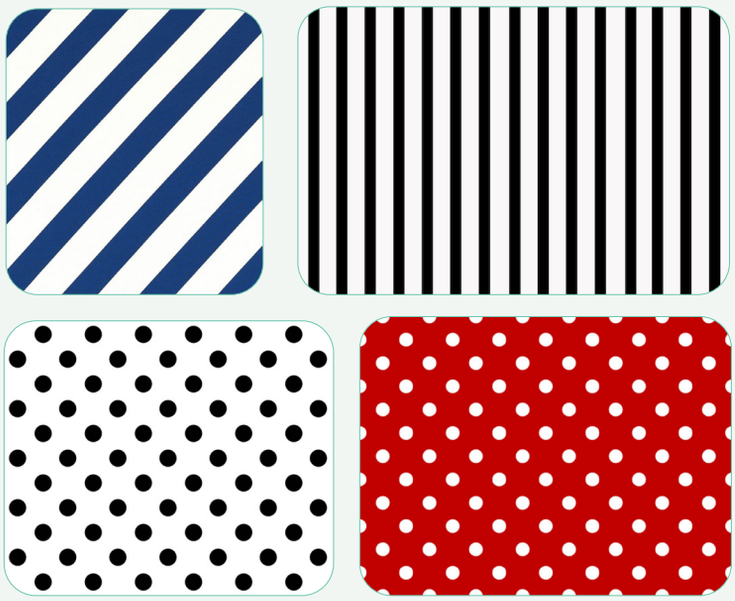
i. **Geometric motifs** (circles, squares):
   - Use shape tools (Rectangle, Ellipse) in Paint/ Word.

ii. **Natural motif** (leaves, wings):

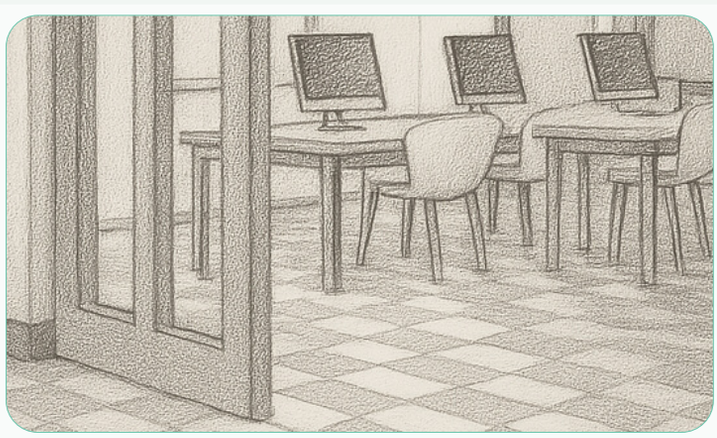
- Use Pencil/ Curve tools to trace a leaf ot wing.

Activity: Motif hunt

- Pupils identify motifs in:
- Their clothing (stripes, polka dots).



- Classroom (tiles, grills, posters).



- Nature (leaf veins, flower petals).

B. Transitioning from hand to digital

Compare:

- Hand-drawn motif (slow, unique).
- Digital motif (fast, editable, repeatable).

Demonstration:

Sketch a simple motif (e.g., a star) on paper, then recreate it in **Microsoft Paint** using:

- Line tool (for sharp edges).
- Copy-paste to duplicate.

3. Application activity

Task 1: Sketch a motif

Pupils draw **one simple motif** (e.g., star, leaf) on paper.

Task 2: Predict digital tools

In pairs, pupils discuss:

- Which tools in Paint/ Word would you use to redraw your motif?

  Possible answers: Different software tools.

Optional hands-on practice:

If devices are available, let Pupils try recreating their motifs in **Paint** using:

- Shapes (for geometric motifs).
- Freeform lines (for natural motifs).

4. Review and conclusion

Recap questions:

- What is the difference between a hand-drawn and digital motif?

  Possible answers: Hand drawn motifs are done by using free hand but ddigital motifs are done using computer

- Name one tool you'd use to draw a leaf motif digitally.

  Possible answers: Microsoft Word or Microsoft Paint.

Showcase: 2-3 Pupils share their sketches and digital tool predictions.

Homework/ Extension:

- Find three motifs at home (e.g., fabric, wallpaper) and sketch them.

e. Assessment

Check for:

- Accuracy in identifying real-world motifs.
- Creativity in hand-drawn motif design.
- Logical tool predictions for digital recreation.

Lesson 2: Creating digital patterns

a. Learning Objective

By the end of the lesson, Pupils should be able to:

- Identify Rwandan cultural motifs (e.g., Imigongo patterns) and brainstorm

digital adaptations.

- Use Microsoft Paint® tools (shapes, fill, copy-paste) to create a repeating pattern.
- Save and export digital artwork properly.

b. Teaching and learning resources

- Computers with Microsoft Paint®.
- Paper/ pencils for sketching.
- Examples of Rwandan patterns (printed or digital).

c. Prerequisites:

Before engaging in the lesson on creating digital motifs, pupils should possess foundational skills in drawing basic shapes and patterns, as well as an understanding of symmetry and repetition. Familiarity with the Microsoft Paint® application or similar digital drawing tools is essential, including knowledge of basic functions such as selecting tools, drawing shapes, and using the fill feature. Additionally, pupils should have prior experience in saving and organizing digital files, ensuring they can store their work appropriately. An appreciation for cultural elements, particularly Rwandan motifs, will enhance their ability to integrate traditional designs into their digital creations.

d. Teaching and learning methodology

1. Introduction

Engage pupils with:

i. What Rwandan patterns (e.g., Imigongo) or stories could we turn into digital art?

Possible answers:

- Traditional Imigongo (black/ white geometric patterns).
- Modern uses (stadium designs, Kigali Convention Center designs).

2. Teaching key concepts

A. Microsoft Paint® basics

What are the benefits of using it?

- Faster: Copy-paste motifs instead of redrawing.
- Neater: Perfect shapes and lines.
- Creative: Experiment with colours easily.

Hands-on demonstration

i. Opening Paint®:
   - Start Menu → Type "Paint" → Press Enter.

ii. Essential Tools:
   - Shapes tool: Draw circles, triangles (like Imigongo lines).
   - Fill bucket: Colour shapes (use Rwanda's green, yellow, blue).
   - Copy-paste (Ctrl+C → Ctrl+V): Duplicate motifs to create patterns.

B. Steps to create a digital pattern

i. Draw a motif:
   - Sketch a simple Rwandan-inspired shape (e.g., zigzag, cow horn, peace basket).

ii. Colour It:
   - Use the fill Tool for bold, traditional colors.

iii. Copy-Paste:
   - Repeat the motif in rows/columns to make a pattern.

iv. Save Work:
   - File → Save As → Name (e.g., "Rwanda_Pattern_1") → Choose PNG/ JPEG.

3. Application activity

Task: Create a Rwandan-inspired digital pattern

i. Design phase
   - Pupils sketch one motif on paper (Rwandan inspired motif).

ii. Digital creation:
   - Recreate the motif in Paint® using Shapes/ Fill Tools.
   - Copy-paste to form a repeating pattern.

iii. Save and share:
   - Save files with names like "Student name_Rwanda Pattern".
   - Volunteers present their designs (projector or printouts).

Teacher's tips:

- Encourage use of traditional colours (black, white, green, yellow).
- Assist with technical issues (e.g., resizing, aligning motifs).

4. Review and conclusion

Recap questions:

- How does copy-paste make pattern-making easier?

- Which Rwandan symbols did we use today?

Homework/ Extension:

- Interview family about traditional Rwandan patterns and sketch 2 new ideas.

e. Assessment

Check for:

- Cultural relevance of motifs.
- Proper use of Paint® tools (shapes, fill, copy-paste).
- Neatness and repetition in the final pattern.

2.6 End of unit assessment

End of unit assessment

Part 1: Knowledge

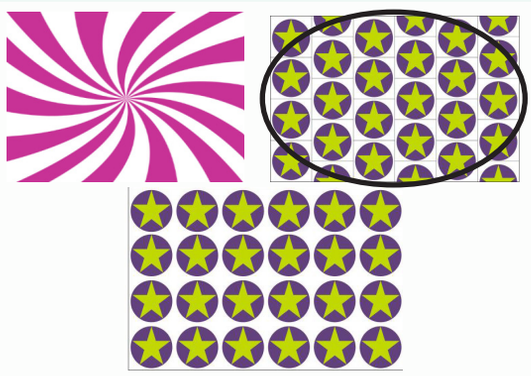
1. Key concepts

i. Define:
- Motif: A motif as a single, individual design idea or element.
- Pattern: A pattern is a repetition of a motif (or several motifs) in an organized way over a space.

ii. Name **two tools** in **Microsoft Paint®** used to create patterns.
- Pencil
- Colour fill
- Brushes
- Eraser

2. Pattern types

Circle the example of a **full-drop repeat**:



Part 2: Skills

3. Digital motif creation

Task: Use **Microsoft Paint®** to:

i. Design *a* **geometric motif** (e.g., triangle and circle combined).

ii. Use the **Fill Tool** to colour it.

iii. Save the file as *"YourName_Motif"*.

4. Pattern design

Task: Create *a* **nature-inspired pattern** (e.g., leaves, hills):

i. Copy and paste your motif to form *a* **full-drop repeat**.

ii. Use **two colours** to enhance the design.

iii. Save as *"YourName_Pattern"*.

Part 3: Attitudes and values

5. Reflection

i. How does using *a* computer **make pattern design easier** than drawing by hand?

Possible answers:

- Computers copy and paste designs instantly.
- You can quickly change colours and sizes.
- It's simple to fix errors without erasing.
- Computers draw straight lines and perfect shapes.
- You can share your designs with friends online.

ii. Why is it important to **respect cultural design**s when creating digital art?

Possible answers:

- It honors their history and traditions.
- It keeps designs special and meaningful.
- It helps everyone feel included.



Talent watch!

The teacher should pay attention to note pupils with special skill in drawing so that the talent can be nurtured. This can be done by enrolling them to the school clubs responsible for art.



Unit 3

DIGITAL SIGNPOST DESIGN

3.1 Key unit competence

Pupils will be able to design a signpost 3D letter and digital poster design

3.2 Learning objectives

At the end of this unit, a pupil should be able to:

Knowledge and understanding

- Different letter styles (bold, uppercase, serif/ sans-serif).
- How shadows and thickness make letters look 3D.
- Ways digital tools (like Paint) can make letters pop!

Skills

- Turn flat letters into 3D letters by hand.
- Use shadows, highlights, and colours to improve designs.

Attitudes and values

- Be creative and precise in your work.
- Value both hand-drawn and digital art!

3.3 Prerequisites

Pupils are expected to have foundational knowledge of typography, including basic letter forms and font types, as well as an understanding of 2D drawing and shading to help visualize depth. Pupils should be able to draw letters, apply shading techniques, and arrange elements in a balanced composition. A creative mindset and the ability to think visually are also essential.

3.4 Guidance on introductory activities

Teacher should begin with engaging warm-up exercises designed to:

- Assess prior knowledge from P5 by having pupils recall/demonstrate basic drawing skills.

- Build confidence through simple, achievable shape-drawing tasks.

Recommended approaches:

- Start with fundamental shapes to establish routines and comfort.
- Use familiar objects (home materials) for freehand practice that feels accessible.

Purpose:

These starter activities allow teachers to:

- Identify individual skill levels (strengths/needs).
- Create an inclusive foundation for all Pupils, including those needing additional support.

3.5 List of lessons

N°	Lesson Title	Learning Objectives	N° of Periods
1	Drawing letters look 3D (using your hands)	• Identification of three dimensional (3D) letters (Freehand) • Demonstration how to draw 3D letters	4
2	Digital signpost design	• Designing a signpost using a computer • Use Microsoft Paint® tools (Text, Shapes, Fill) to create 3D lettering.	5
3	End of unit 3 assessment		1

Lesson 1: Making letters look 3D (using your hands)

a. Learning objective

By the end of the lesson, pupils will be able to:

- Understand the three key features of 3D letters.
- Apply a 4-step process to transform flat letters into 3D block letters.

b. Teaching and learning resources

- Pencils, erasers, rulers, paper.
- Examples of 3D letters (e.g., Tour du Rwanda logos).

c. Prerequisites

Before beginning this lesson, pupils should have basic knowledge of letters and the alphabet, including their shapes and proportions. They should also understand simple 2D drawing concepts such as lines, shapes, and spacing. Pupils are expected

to have the skill to draw letters freehand, use pencils and paper appropriately, and apply simple techniques like outlining and shading.

d. Teaching and learning methodology

1. Introduction

Engage pupils with questions:

i. How do you think these letters pop out like blocks? (Show 3D letter examples.)

ii. Where have you seen 3D letters? (Posters, shop signs, logos like Tour du Rwanda.)

Demonstration:

- Quickly sketch a flat "A," then convert it to 3D using the steps below.

2. Teaching key concepts

A. What makes letters 3D?

i. **Thickness:** Like a cardboard box edge (all sides equal depth).

ii. **Shadows:** Darkest on the side *opposite* the light source.

iii. **Highlights:** Bright spots where light hits directly.

B. 4-Step drawing process (Demonstrate on board)

Step 1: Draw a block letter: Use big, bold letters.

Step 2: Add diagonal lines: From *every corner*, draw slanted lines (45° angle, all same direction!).

Step 3: Connect the lines: Close the "sides" to form thickness.

Step 4: Shade the sides: Darken the left/right sides (imagining light from top-right).

Common mistake alert: Mixed-angle lines ruin the 3D effect!

3. Application activity

Task: 3D letter "T"

i. **Sketch:** Draw a block "T" (use ruler for clean edges).

ii. **Add Depth:** Apply the 4 steps to make it 3D.

iii. **Shade:** Use cross-hatching or solid shading for shadows.

Extension:

- Advanced pupils add highlights with an eraser or white chalk.

Teacher's tips:

- Walk around to check:
  - Are all oblique lines parallel?
  - Is shading consistent?

4. Review and conclusion

Recap questions:

- Why must all slanting lines face the same way?

Showcase:

- 3 Pupils display their 3D "T" and explain their shading choices.

Homework:

- Design a 3D version of your name's first letter.

e. Assessment

Check for:

- Correct use of oblique lines (uniform angles).
- Logical shadow placement.
- Neatness and boldness of letters.

Lesson 2: Digital Signpost design

a. Learning Objective

By the end of the lesson, Pupils should be able to:

- Plan a poster's purpose and layout.
- Use Microsoft Paint® tools (Text, Shapes, Fill) to create 3D lettering.
- Explain why 3D letters improve posters (real-world applications).

b. Teaching and learning resources

- Computers with Microsoft Paint®.
- Paper/ pencils for planning.
- Examples of Rwandan posters/ signs (digital or printed).

c. Prerequisites

The Prerequisites for a lesson on Digital 3D Letters includes basic computer skills to confidently navigate design software and manage digital files. Pupils should have a foundational understanding of 2D letterforms and typography, including knowledge of letter shapes, spacing, and alignment.

d. Teaching and learning methodology

1. Introduction

Engage with a question:

Imagine designing a poster for your school's sports day:

- How could you make the title stand out?
  - Example: "PEACE" (larger, 3D) vs. "CLUB" (smaller).

Show real-world examples:

- Rwandan shop signs (e.g., "UBUZIMA PHARMACY" in bold 3D letters).
- Discuss: "Why do businesses use digital posters instead of hand-drawn?"

  Answers: Faster edits, brighter colors, professional look.

2. Teaching key concepts

Part A: Planning your poster

i. **Purpose first:**
   - Is it for an **event**, **safety rule**, or **advertisement**?
   - Sketch a rough layout (pencil/ paper).

Part B: Digital tools in Paint® (Live Demonstration)

i. Text tool:
   - Type words in **Arial Black** (bold, sans-serif).

3. Application activity

Task 1: Tool detective

- Pupils list 2 Paint® tools they used (e.g., Fill Tool, Line Tool) and explain their purpose.

Task 2: Design challenge

i. Create **3D letters A-H** in Paint®:
   - Use the 4-step method from Lesson 3.2.
   - Color fronts bright, sides dark.

ii. Design a mini-poster with: A title in 3D (e.g., "READ").
   - One shape icon (e.g., book emoji).

Task 3: Think deeper

Discuss: *"How do 3D letters make posters stand out?"*

- Answers: Look professional, grab attention, show depth.

4. Review and conclusion

Recap questions:

i. Which tool helps color letters quickly? *(Fill Tool.)*

ii. Why slant all 3D lines the same way? *(For consistency.)*

Showcase work: 2-3 pupils present posters. Class votes on "Most Eye-Catching."

Homework: Redesign a hand-drawn school notice digitally (e.g., "WASH HANDS").

e. Assessment

Check for:

- 3D Letters: Correct angles, shading.
- Layout: Clear hierarchy (key words largest).
- Creativity: Use of colours/ shapes.

3.6 End of unit assessment

End of unit assessment

Part 1: Knowledge

A. Multiple choice

Circle the correct answer.

1. What gives letters a 3D effect?
   a. Using many colours
   b. Shadows and thickness
   c. Making them very small
2. Which digital tool is best for filling letters with colour?
   a. Pencil tool
   b. Fill tool
   c. Eraser
3. Why might a shop owner prefer digital posters?
   a. They are harder to read
   b. They look more professional and can be edited easily
   c. They take longer to make
4. In 3D lettering, all slanted lines should:
   a. Point in random directions
   b. Point the same direction
   c. Be curved

Part 2: Skills

B. Practical tasks

Task 1: Hand-drawn 3D letter

- Draw the letter "R" in block form.
- Transform it into 3D by:
  - Adding thickness (consistent slant direction)
  - Shading one side to show shadows
  - Leaving one side bright for highlights

Task 2: Digital poster design

Using **Microsoft Paint®**:

1. Design a **"Sports Day"** poster with:
2. Save your work as **"YourName_Poster"**.

Part 3: Attitudes and values

C. Reflection

Answer in full sentences:

1. How did planning your design first help your poster?

   Possible answer: Planning my design first helped because I knew where to put everything, so my poster didn't get messy and all the important stuff fit.

2. Why is it important to keep slanted lines consistent in 3D letters?

   Possible answer: It is important so that the shadow looks the same on every letter, making the word look like it's really standing up straight.

3. Give one example where 3D letters are used in your community.

   Possible answer: You can see 3D letters on the big sign outside my favorite ice cream shop!



Talent watch!

The teacher should pay attention to note pupils with special skill in drawing so that the talent can be nurtured. This can be done by enrolling them to the school clubs responsible for art.



Unit 4

INTRODUCTION TO SEWING

4.1 Key unit competence

Pupils will be able to apply sewing techniques, repair clothes and apply simple design on a surface and fixing button.

4.2 Learning objectives

At the end of this unit, a pupil should be able to:

Knowledge and understanding

- What sewing is (functional + decorative) and its cultural importance in Rwanda.
- Names, uses, and safety rules for tools (needles, scissors, thread, sewing machines).
- Foundational stitches: Running, Backstitch, Whip, Satin, Blanket, Cross.

Skills

- Safely use tools and practice stitches on fabric scraps.
- Sew buttons, mend tears, and hem edges with precision.
- Complete a simple project (e.g., patch, pillowcase) to showcase skills.

Attitudes and values

- Value patience, creativity, and sustainability (repairing vs. discarding).
- Take pride in creating useful items and helping others with repairs.

4.3 Prerequisites

Before pupils begin , they should already be comfortable using essential tools (like scissors, pins, needles, seam ripper, iron, threads, bobbins), be able to handsew simple stitches (running, backstitch) on scrap fabric, understand key fabric basics (cutting with grain, identifying fabric sides, etc.), and recognize fundamental terms (straight vs zigzag stitch ,etc.); having this foundation ensures they focus on

applying repairs and simple decorative techniques effectively rather than learning tool operation and terminology from scratch.

4.4 Guidance on introductory activities

Introductory activity

Mugabo's shirt got torn, so he tried to fix it with tape but the tape peeled off, then he used glue but the glue dried and cracked. Finally, his Mama took a needle and a thread, sewed the torn cloth properly,

Pupils read the story above and the teacher prompt them with written questions.



1. What else can we fix with sewing?

   Ripped stuffed toys, Broken bag straps, Torn curtains or pillowcases, Loose buttons, Shoe scratches

2. Why does sewing work better than tape or glue on clothes?

   Stronger: *Thread won't peel like tape after washing.*

   Stretchy: *Sewing moves with the fabric (glue gets stiff and cracks).*

   Neater: *No sticky blobs or wrinkles (just tiny, hidden stitches).*

   Lasts longer: *Tape falls off; sewing stays forever (or until you undo it).*

   Washable: *Glue melts in the wash... but thread? No problem!*

4.5 List of lessons

N°	Lesson Title	Objectives	Number of Periods
1	Types of stitches	• Able to identify, demonstrate, and apply various hand sewing stitches. • Repair effectively clothes and create decorative designs on fabric.	3
2	Sewing a button using backstitch	• Able to securely attach a button using backstitch. • Create a proper thread shank (a shank is a device for providing a small amount of space in between a cloth and a button.	2

3	Repairing ripped cloth with running stitch	• Repair a rip in fabric using an evenly spaced running stitch. • Understand that this simple yet versatile stitch is ideal for mending everyday tears quickly and neatly.	2
4	End of unit 4 assessment		1

Lesson 1: Types of stitches

c. Learning Objective:

By the end of the lesson, Pupils should be able to:

- Identify two basic stitches (running stitch and backstitch) and their uses.
- Demonstrate how to sew a running stitch and backstitch on fabric.
- Apply the right stitch for different repair scenarios (e.g., torn straps vs. buttons).

d. Teaching and learning resources

- Blunt needles, thread/yarn, fabric scraps, paper.
- Visual aids: Stitch diagrams, real-world examples (e.g., mended clothes).

e. Prerequisites

To ensure pupils are well-prepared, they should come in knowing how to sit with good posture, well workspace, use needles safely (including a thimble to protect their fingers), and thread needles and tie secure starting/finishing knots using a needle threader. They should also be comfortable tracing and cutting fabric neatly (especially felt), aware of fabric grain and tension, and able to manage a suitable thread length (about 18–24″) while pulling stitches neither too tight nor too loose. Finally, a bit of hand eye coordination practice like tracing a line and making evenly spaced dots or stitches along it will help them confidently begin learning and applying stitches such as running stitch, backstitch, blanket stitch, and whip stitch for both repair and decorative purposes.

f. Teaching and learning methodology

1. Introduction

Engage with a story:

- Your favorite teddy bear's arm is falling off! What can you use to fix him?
- Discuss: Needle, thread, and stitches as "drawing with thread."

Show Real-life Examples:

- Running stitch = Dashes (– – –) for quick fixes (like basting fabric).
- Backstitch = Solid line (====) for strong repairs (like bag straps).
- Connect to Rwandan culture: "Just like imigongo art, stitches can be both useful and beautiful!"

2. Teaching key concepts

A. Running Stitch

- Looks like: Small, even dashes (footprints in sand).
- Best for: Temporary fixes (e.g., holding fabric before final sewing).
- How to do it (Demonstration on board/ Fabric):
  i. Push needle up through fabric.
  ii. Take a small stitch forward (~0.5 cm).
  iii. Repeat in a straight line.

B. Backstitch

- Looks like: Unbroken line
- Best for: Strong repairs (e.g., teddy bear arms, bag straps).
- How to do it (Demonstration):
  i. Stitch forward, then bring needle back to end of last stitch.
  ii. Push needle through again, overlapping stitches.
- Why strong? Each stitch locks into the next!

Common mistakes:

- Running stitch: Uneven gaps → weak repair.
- Backstitch: Skipping overlaps → breaks easily.

3. Application activity

Task 1: Stitch match-up

Which stitch for each problem?

i. Torn school bag strap? → Backstitch (needs strength).
ii. Loose button? → Backstitch (must hold weight).
iii. Quick stuffed animal fix? → Running stitch (temporary).

Task 2: Hands-on practice

i. Running Stitch on paper:

- Use a blunt needle/yarn to practice dashes on paper.

ii. Backstitch on fabric scraps:
- Sew a short line on cloth (teacher checks for overlaps).

Teacher's tips:
- Pre-punch holes in paper for younger Pupils.
- Use contrasting thread colors for visibility.

4. Review and conclusion

Recap questions:
- Which stitch would you use to fix a backpack? Why?
- How is a backstitch like a zipper? (Both interlock for strength!)

Showcase work:
- Pupils display their best backstitch line on fabric.

Homework:
- Find one item at home that needs stitching (e.g., loose button) and identify the best stitch.

g. Assessment

Check for:
- Correct stitch technique (even spacing for running stitch, overlaps for backstitch).
- Accurate problem-solving in "Stitch Match-Up."

Lesson 2: Sewing a button using backstitch

a. Learning Objective

By the end of the lesson, Pupils should be able to:
- Explain why backstitch is stronger than running stitch for buttons.
- Demonstrate how to sew a button securely using the 5-step method.
- Create a thread shank for flat buttons to allow movement.

b. Teaching and learning resources

- Needles (blunt for younger Pupils), thread, buttons, fabric scraps, scissors.
- Visual aids: Button samples, stitch diagram posters.

c. Prerequisites

Before starting this lesson, pupils should already know how to thread a needle and tie secure knots, use thimbles safely, handle scissors and fabric neatly, and perform basic hand stitches like running stitch and backstitch for simple seams. They should also have developed fine motor coordination such as following a drawn line and stitching evenly and understand the importance of using a doubled thread for strength. These foundational skills ensure they're ready to confidently move on to anchoring buttons, forming a sturdy shank, and securely fastening buttons using the backstitch method

d. Teaching and learning methodology

1. Introduction

Engage with observation:

i. Show a picture of someone sewing a button (or demonstrate live).
   - What tools do you see? Why is the person using a needle and thread instead of glue?

ii. Compare stitches:
   - Running stitch (– – –)= Temporary (like sticky tape).
   - Backstitch (====)= Permanent (like super glue).

Real-world connection:

"Have you ever lost a button on your school shirt? A backstitch keeps it from falling again!"

2. Teaching key concepts

A. Why backstitch for buttons?

- Strength: Each stitch locks into the next (like a zipper).
- Durability: Withstands pulling (e.g., buttoning/unbuttoning).

B. 5-Step button sewing demonstration (Do slowly while Pupils follow)

Step 1: Get ready

- Thread needle (double thread for strength).
- Tie **two knots** at the end.

Step 2: Mark the spot

- From fabric back, sew a tiny **'X'** where the button goes.

Step 3: Attach button

- Place button over 'X.'

- Push needle up through one hole, down through the opposite hole.
- Repeat 3-4 times per hole pair (for 4-hole buttons: sew parallel lines or 'X').

Step 4: Make a Shank (For flat buttons)

- Lift button slightly, **wind thread under it 6 times** (use a matchstick to create space).

Step 5: Finish securely

- Tie two knots on the fabric back.
- Cut excess thread.

Teacher tips:

- Use **contrasting thread** so pupils can see stitches clearly.
- For young pupils: Pre-thread needles to save time.

3. Application activity

Task 1: Guided practice

- Pupils follow along as you re-demonstrate each step slowly.
  - Pause after Step 2 to check 'X' marks.
  - Pause after Step 4 to inspect shanks.

Task 2: Independent sewing

- Pupils sew buttons onto fabric scraps:
  - **Beginners:** 2-hole buttons (parallel stitches).
  - **Advanced:** 4-hole buttons ('X' pattern).

Common mistakes to fix:

- Loose stitches → Show how to pull thread snug.
- Uneven shanks → Demonstrate winding technique again.

4. Review and conclusion

Recap questions:

- Why do we wind thread under the button? (To create movement space.)
- How is backstitch stronger than running stitch? (Locks like a zipper.)

Showcase work:

- Pupils hold up buttons and test flexibility (gentle tug!).

Homework:

- Sew a button onto an old cloth at home (e.g., pillowcase).

e. Assessment

Check for:

- Correct backstitch technique (no gaps between stitches).
- Secure knots and proper shank (if applicable).
- Button functionality (does it lie flat but move freely?).

Lesson 3: Repairing ripped cloth with running stitch

a. Learning Objective

By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

- Explain why the running stitch is useful for quick fabric repairs.
- Demonstrate how to mend a tear using the 3-step running stitch method.
- Advocate for repairing clothes.

b. Teaching and learning resources:

- Fabric scraps with pretend tears (or real torn clothes).
- Blunt needles, thread, safety pins, scissors.
- Visual aids: Stitch diagram, "Why Repair?" poster.

c. Prerequisites

Before engaging in the lesson on repairing ripped cloth with a running stitch, pupils should have mastered fundamental hand sewing skills. These include threading a needle, tying secure knots, and executing basic stitches such as the running stitch and backstitch. Additionally, they should be adept at preparing fabric by turning it inside out and aligning edges, as well as maintaining consistent stitch length and spacing to ensure neat and durable repairs. Familiarity with tools like thimbles, fabric scissors, and embroidery floss is also essential. These foundational skills will enable pupils to effectively mend fabric tears using the running stitch, ensuring both functionality and aesthetics in their repairs.

d. Teaching and learning methodology

1. Introduction

Engage with discussion:

i. Show a picture of a torn shirt or use a fabric scrap with a pretend tear.
   - *"What happens if we don't fix this rip?"* (Gets bigger, becomes unwearable.)

- *"Can we fix it with just a needle and thread?"* (Yes—with running stitch!)

Why repair clothes?

- Saves money: No need to buy new clothes.
- Less rubbish: Reduces textile waste (link to environmental care).
- Helps others: Donate repaired clothes to those in need.

2. Teaching key concepts

A. Why use running stitch?

- Easy: Up-and-down motion (like dotted lines).
- Versatile: Works on shirts, jeans, stuffed animals.
- Low-cost: Needs only basic tools (needle, thread, scissors).

B. 3-Step Repair demonstration (Do slowly while Pupils watch)

Step 1: Get ready

- Turn fabric **inside out**.
- Use **safety pins** to hold edges together (like a plaster).

Step 2: Sew the Dots

- Start past the tear (for strength).
- Make small, even stitches (size of a little fingernail).
- *Teacher tip:* Mark stitch spacing with a washable pen if needed.

Step 3: Finish properly

- Sew **2 strong stitches** at the end.
- Tie a **hidden knot** inside the fabric.
- *Golden rule:* "Don't pull too hard, gentle hands prevent puckering!"

3. Application activity

Task 1: Hands-on practice

Pupils repair a **pretend tear** on fabric scraps:

i. Pin edges with safety pins.
ii. Sew running stitches along the tear.
iii. Tie knots and trim excess thread.

Task 2: Circle the correct answer

Why is fixing clothes good?

- Saves money, Less rubbish, Helps people.

Task 3: Be a teacher

In pairs, Pupils teach:

- How to hold a needle safely (thumb + index finger).
- How to tie a knot (wrap thread around finger, pull tight).
- Finger safety (keep fingers away from the needle tip).

4. Review and conclusion

Recap questions:

- "Where should you start stitching a tear?" (Past the rip, for strength.)
- "Why do we use small, even stitches?" (Prevents gaps and weak spots.)

Showcase work:

- Pupils hold up repairs and test strength (gentle tug!).

Homework:

- Find one torn item at home (e.g., sock, pillowcase) and practice mending it.

e. Assessment

Check for:

- Even, small stitches along the tear.
- Secure knots and neat finishes.
- Safety awareness (needle handling).

4.6 End of unit 4 assessment

End of unit assessment

Part 1: Knowledge

A. Multiple choice

Circle the correct answer.

1. Which of the following stitches is best for temporary fixes?
   a. Backstitch
   b. Running stitch
   c. Blanket stitch
2. What tool is essential for sewing a button securely from the list below?
   a. Glue
   b. Stapler
   c. Needle and thread

3. From the list below, why is a shank important when sewing buttons?
   a. To make the button shine
   b. To allow space for fabric thickness
   c. To hide the thread
4. Complete the statement with one answer from the list below. Repairing clothes helps the environment because it ***Reduces waste.***
   a. Reduces waste
   b. Uses more electricity
   c. Makes clothes heavier

Part 2: Skills

B. Practical tasks

Task 1: Sew a button

- Attach a **button** to fabric using backstitch.

Part 3: Attitudes and values

C. Reflection

Answer in full sentences:

i. Why is it valuable to **repair clothes** instead of throwing them away?
Repairing clothes is good because it saves money, helps the Earth, and lets us keep wearing our favorite things instead of throwing them away!



Talent watch!

The teacher should pay attention to note pupils with special skill in drawing so that the talent can be nurtured. This can be done by enrolling them to the school clubs responsible for art.

PART II: MUSIC

SAMPLE LESSON PLAN (Music)

School name ……. Academic year: ….……

Teachers' Name……

Term	Date	Subject	Class	Unit	Topic	Timing	Number of learners
1	**……..**	**Music**	**P6**	**1**	**2 of 4**	**40mins**	**…….**
Pupils with special needs education			2 pupils with hearing disability				
Unit Title			Simple time signatures				
Key unit competence			Pupils will be able to read and write music notes respecting time signatures.				
Lesson			Time Signature				
Instructional Objective			Using musical staves, different musical equipment and musical instruments, pupil will be able to group notes and beats into measures and sing sol-fa notes on the musical staff within the C scale correctly.				
Learning and teaching environment			The lesson will be delivered in the classroom.				
Learning and teaching materials			Musical staves, different musical equipment, musical instruments or pictures showing different musical instruments, Audio and video sets.				
Books and references			REB (2025). *Primary six Creative Arts-Fine Arts and Music, Teacher's Guide*, p. 46-48 REB (2025). *Primary six Creative Arts-Fine Arts and Music, Pupil's book*, p.42-44				

Stages and timing	Description of teaching and learning activities		Cross cutting issues
	Teacher's activities	Learners' activities	
Introduction: **5 min**	Guide pupils to revise the concepts of time signatures such as: beat, bar, barline and the numerals of a time signature. Show a musical staff containing a time signature and notes. Ask the pupils to identify the number of beats that are in each bar. Ask the pupils to comment on what they see by asking them different questions leading to the new lesson.	Revise the concepts of time signatures such as: beat, bar, barline and the numerals of a time signature. Observe the musical staff containing a time signature and notes Identify the number of beats that are in each bar and comment on what they see by answering different questions asked by the teacher.	**Inclusive education** Same opportunities in sharing views without discrimination. **Critical thinking** This will be addressed by asking pupils to compare the time signature and the number of beats that are in 2/4 time signature.
2. Body of the lesson			
2.1 Activity 1 **10 min**	Guide them to sing the song "Happy birthday" and show them how 2/4 time signature is used with it. Show the beats of 2/4 time signature by explaining the strong and weak beat.	Sing the song "Happy birthday" and observe how 2/4 time signature is used with it Imitate how to conduct 2/4 time signature respecting the two beats (both strong and weak beat)	**Peace and values Education** While pupil is listening to a teacher and a classmate attentively.

2.2. Activity 2 **10 min**	Form groups and assign the task of grouping beats in two four time signature and find different songs in 2/4 time signature.	Join groups and discuss how the grouping is done in 2/4 time signature and find different songs in 2/4 time signature.	**Critical thinking** This is addressed when pupils share ideas when explaining the groupings. **Cooperation** It will be addressed through sharing ideas in groups.
2.3. Activity 3 **5 min**	Guide them to present their findings before the peers. They perform their songs and conduct the 2/4 time signature.	Present their findings before the peers. They perform their songs and conduct the 2/4 time signature.	Gender balance: This is addressed when pupils both boys and girls perform together.
2.4. Conclusion **Summary** **5 min**	Bring together all groups and ask each group to perform their own song. Ask pupil to imitate each group which performed well.	Each group performs in the way they have prepared respecting 2/4 time signature. Choosing the group which performed well and congratulating it. All pupils perform the song together.	**Cooperation** Pupils sing together.
3. Assessment: **5 min.**	Ask pupils to perform the song respecting 2/4 time signature as they have learned and to group notes and beats into measures .	Perform the song respecting 2/4 time signature as they have learned and group notes and beats into measures.	**Inclusive education** Giving a learner with physical impairment and opportunity to be chosen among others.

Self-assessment (Teacher)	• Make sure the objectives have been achieved (Example: The objectives provided for have been achieved) • Analyze the reason why the lesson has been understood or not (example: the reason why the lesson has been understood, is because all learners like music subject), • Deciding what will be considered in the next lesson (Example: For the next lesson, each learner will sing on his/her own).

CONTENT MAP FOR MUSIC SUBJECT, PRIMARY SIX

No	Unit titles	Proposed key unit competences	Proposed periods per unit
1	Simple time signatures	Pupils will be able to read and write music notes respecting time signatures.	11 periods
2	Bass staff and grand staff.	Pupils will be able to write and read notes on the grand staff.	7 periods
3	Piano practice	Pupils will be able to play simple songs on the keyboard.	15 periods
Total			**33**



Unit 1

SIMPLE TIME SIGNATURES

1.1 Key unit competence:

At the end of this unit, each pupil will be able to read and write music notes respecting time signatures.

Learning objectives

Knowledge	Skills	Attitudes and Values
Understand what a time signature is and where it is placed in music notation.	Clap, tap, or play rhythms correctly based on $\frac{2}{4}$, $\frac{3}{4}$, and $\frac{4}{4}$, time.	• Show enthusiasm in practicing rhythms and participating in group rhythmic activities. • Be attentive to keeping correct timing when performing music.
Identify common simple time signatures such as $\frac{2}{4}$, $\frac{3}{4}$, and $\frac{4}{4}$.	Read and perform short pieces written in different simple time signatures.	• Appreciate the role of time and rhythm in organizing musical pieces. • Develop self-discipline through counting and timing.
Know how to count beats in each time signature.	Write simple rhythmic patterns using appropriate time signatures.	• Cooperate with others in group music activities that require synchronized timing.
Recognize how time signatures organize rhythm in music.	Combine note values and bar lines correctly within a given time signature.	• Respect the structure and rules of music while expressing creativity.

1.2 Prerequisites

- Know common note durations.
- Recognize the difference between treble and bass clefs.
- Identify steady beats (like clapping or tapping to a regular pulse).
- Differentiate fast beats from slow beats.
- Understand the structure of the musical staff (5 lines,4 spaces).

1.3 Introductory activity and guidance

Introductory activity 1

One sunny afternoon, Amina and her friends were playing drums in the schoolyard. Amina tapped: *tap–tap–tap–tap*, and everyone followed easily. Then Cyuzuzo took over and played: *tap–tap–tap, tap–tap–tap*. Then Amina asked, "What made the rhythm feel different? Could there be a special rule in music that helps us to organize beats?

Guidance on the introductory activity

The teacher will present the scenario and ask the pupils to read it individually, silently and then loudly. The teacher will use question-answer techniques to guide the pupils to discover the lesson on time signatures. The teacher will clap and demonstrate different beats as the scenario has shown. The teacher will guide the pupils to discuss different concepts related to time signatures especially those from the scenario. The teacher will introduce some music concepts on beats.

Possible answer to the introductory activity

"In music, beats are grouped into patterns called time signatures. Amina's rhythm is like a 4-beat pattern (called $\frac{4}{4}$) while Cyuzuzo's is in 3-beat groups (like $\frac{3}{4}$)." Write $\frac{2}{4}$, $\frac{3}{4}$, and $\frac{4}{4}$ on the board and simply explain what they mean (how many beats per measure).

There is a special rule in music that helps us organize beats by tapping/clapping the beats in accordance with the time signatures.

1.4 Cross cutting issues to be addressed

Peace and values education

This is addressed through group activities where pupils develop values of patience, respect, cooperation, unity, and appreciation for one another talents. They learn to wait for their turn, listen to others, and work harmoniously.

Gender balance

This is addressed when a teacher forms groups of pupils and mixes boys and girls so that they sing together. The teacher gives both boys and girls equal opportunities to give answers, views etc.

Inclusive education

This is addressed by allowing all pupils including those who have different disabilities to participate equally in the teaching and learning process. i.e. none of the pupils is left behind; all of them are given opportunities to give answers, views and are assisted when needed.

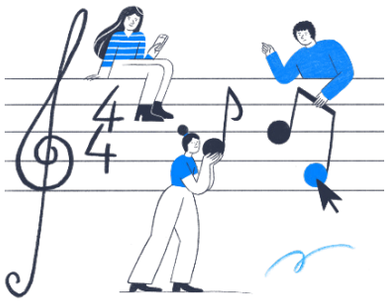
Critical thinking

This will be addressed by asking pupils to compare different time signatures and think about why one might feel easier or harder.

1.5 List of Lessons of unit one

N°	Content	General objectives	Number of periods
1	Concepts of simple time signature	Identify and define a time signature in written music. Recognize the most common simple time signatures: $\frac{2}{4}$, $\frac{3}{4}$, and $\frac{4}{4}$. Count beats correctly according to the time signature while performing or listening to music. Group notes and beats correctly into measures when singing notes or writing simple melodies using musical notations. Sight sing simple melodies in $\frac{2}{4}$, $\frac{3}{4}$, and $\frac{4}{4}$ time signatures	1
2	$\frac{2}{4}$ Time Signature		3
3	$\frac{3}{4}$ Time Signature		3
4	$\frac{4}{4}$ Time Signature		3
6	End of unit assessment		1

Lesson 1: Concepts of time signatures



a. Learning objectives

To identify and define time signatures, recognize common simple time signatures such as $\frac{2}{4}$, $\frac{3}{4}$, and $\frac{4}{4}$ correctly group notes and beats into measures when reading or writing simple rhythms, and sing sol-fa notes on the musical staff within the C scale.

b. Teaching and learning resources

- Musical staves.
- Different musical equipment.
- Pictures showing different musical instruments.
- Audio and video sets.

c. Teaching and learning activities

In this lesson, "**Concepts of time signatures**", the teacher will help pupils to know different concepts related to time signatures through brainstorming, questions and answers, manipulation, group discussion and other techniques.

Possible answer to learning activity 1.1

1. We group beats in music to make it easier to read, play and understand a music composition. Grouping beats into bars helps musicians know where strong and weak beats are, keep a steady rhythm and play together in time. It's like organizing words into sentences—music becomes clearer when it is divided into parts.
2. The bars/measures and lines help us organize beats and make rhythms easier to follow.

Possible answer to learning activity 1.2

1. Two crotchets (quarter notes).
2. Four crotchets (quarter notes).
3. Eight crotchets (quarter notes).

Introduction

In the introduction of the lesson, the teacher shows a musical staff containing a time signature, bar, barlines and notes. The teacher asks the pupils to comment on what they see by asking them different questions leading to the new lesson.

Body of the lesson

Beat:

Definition: The beat is the steady pulse in music, like a heartbeat.

- Clap a steady beat while the pupils walk or tap along. Play music with a clear beat.
- Let the pupils feel and move with the beat (March, clap, tap).

Bar (or Measure)

Definition: A bar is a group of beats put together in music.

- Draw four dots on the board, separated by vertical lines: • • • • | • • • • |
- Count and clap four beats at a time. Every four counts, say "new bar!" or raise a hand.

Barline

Definition: A bar line is the vertical line that separates one bar (group of beats) from another.

- On the board or chart, show how bar-lines look like between groups of beats.
- Let the pupils draw beats and bar-lines on mini-whiteboards or in their book notes.

Time Signatures

Definition: A time signature tells us how many beats are in each bar.

- Focus on Simple Time Signatures: $\frac{2}{4}$, $\frac{3}{4}$, and $\frac{4}{4}$.
- Explain the role of the two numerals that make a time signature.
- The top number = how many beats per bar.
- The bottom number = type of note (e.g., quarter note).
- Show a $\frac{4}{4}$ time signature on the board and clap four beats per bar with pupils.
- Clap $\frac{2}{4}$, $\frac{3}{4}$, and $\frac{4}{4}$ patterns.
- Use body percussion or simple instruments (e.g., shakers, drums).
- Ask pupils to sing any song familiar to them by accompanying it with claps.

Application activity 1.1

1. What is a beat?

   Answer: A beat is a steady, repeating pulse in music, like a heartbeat.

2. How does a bar/measure differ from the beat?

   Answer: A beat is the basic steady repeating pulse in music like a heartbeat or a regular tap while a bar (or measure) constitutes a group of beats put together

and separated by barlines. So, a beat is a single unit of time, while a bar/measure is a collection of beats (for example, there may be 2, 3, or 4 beats in one bar/measure).

3. What is the purpose of bar lines?

   Answer: Bar-lines are vertical lines in music that separate one bar from another. Their purpose is to help organize the beats into regular groups, making music easier to read, count, and play. They show where each bar (or measure) begins and ends, helping musicians stay in time.

4. What do the numerals of a time signature tell the performer?

   Answer: The numerals of a time signature tell the performer how to count beats in music. The **top number** tells how many beats are in each bar (e.g., $\frac{2}{4}$,in time signature 2 means two beats per bar/measure). The **bottom number** tells what kind of note gets one beat (e.g., in $\frac{2}{4}$ time signature, 4 means a quarter note gets one beat).

Lesson 2: $\frac{2}{4}$ Time Signature

a. Learning objectives

To define a time signature in written music, recognize and interpret the $\frac{2}{4}$ time signature, count beats accurately while performing or listening, group notes and beats correctly into measures, sight-sing a short melody in $\frac{2}{4}$ time, and express rhythm confidently using voice, body percussion, or musical instruments.



b. Teaching and learning resources

- Musical staves.
- Different musical equipmen.
- Pictures showing different musical instruments,
- Audio and video sets.

c. Teaching and Learning activities

In this lesson **" $\frac{2}{4}$ time signature"**, the teacher will help the pupils to know different beats related to different time signatures through brainstorming, questions and answers, manipulation, group discussion and other techniques.

This lesson has three periods and will contain the following activities:

Introduction

- The teacher shows a musical staff containing a $\frac{2}{4}$ time signature and notes.
- The teacher asks the pupils to identify the number of beats that are in each bar.
- The teacher asks the pupils to comment on what they see by asking them different questions leading to the new lesson.

Body of the lesson

- The teacher guides the pupils to understand the $\frac{2}{4}$ time signature basing on the number of beats and the values of notes to be used.
- The teacher shows the pupils how beats are counted in a bar.

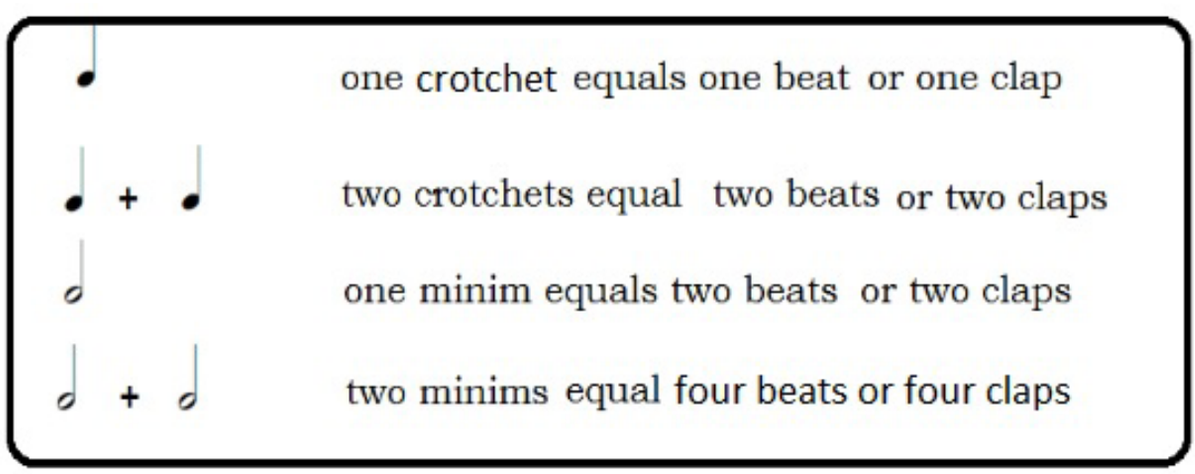
If you clap your hands **once (**one time)**,** you have **one beat** or one clap.

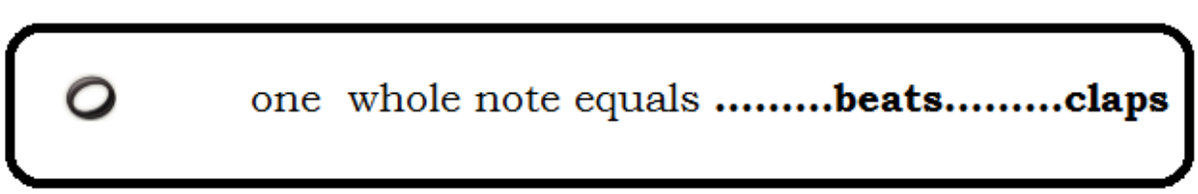
If you clap your hands **twice (**two times)**,** you have **two beats** or two claps.

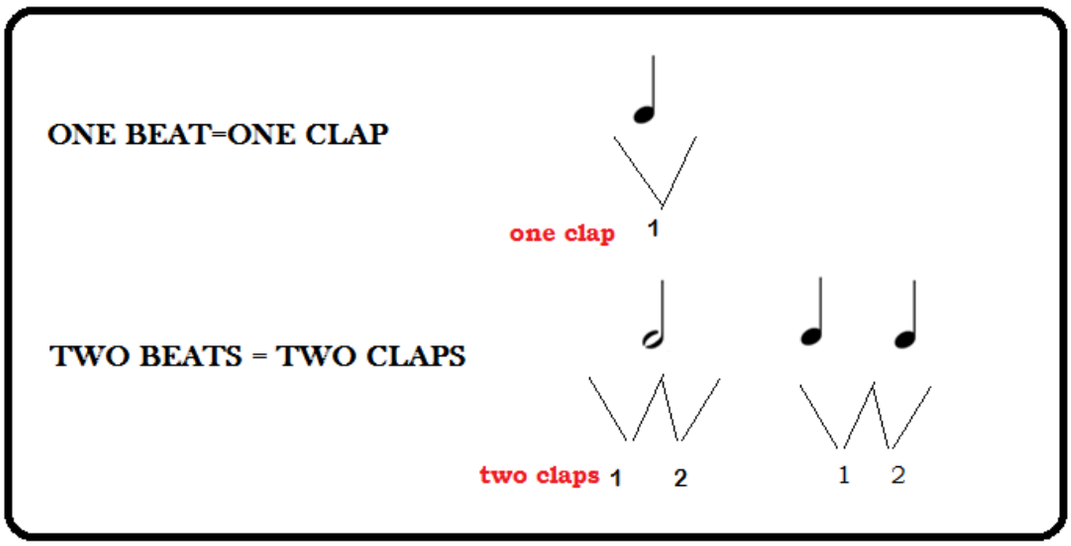
If you clap your hands **thrice** (three times), you have **three beats** or three claps.

If you clap your hands **four times**, you have **four beatsor** four claps.









The teacher guides the pupils to sing the notes, respecting the time signature, by clapping their hands.

Remember that: one quarter note equals one beat or one clap. One half note equals two beats or two claps.



After sol-fa singing, the teacher helps the pupils to sing the song Rwanda Rwatubyaye or happy birthday.

Answers for activities

Learning activity 1.3

Observe the following melody and tell the number of beats that are in each bar:



Answer to learning activity 1.3

There are **2 beats** in each bar/measure of the melody

Answer to leaning activity 1.4

Check if pupils are singing (TA, TA ...) respecting the beats of the notes. One crotchet (quarter note) is worth 1 beat equals one clap. But the half note equals two beats or two clap.

Answers to application activity 1.2

1. How many beats are there in a bar of time signature?

   ***Answer**: There are two beats in a bar of time signature*

2. Sing the following melodies respecting time signature.



   Guidance: The teacher makes sure that all the the pupils are able to read the notes correctly and provide assistance to those who fail to read them.

3. Fill in missing notes to complete the given time signature.



   Answer:



Lesson 3: $\frac{3}{4}$ Time signature

a. Learning objectives

To define a time signature in written music, recognize and interpret the $\frac{3}{4}$ time signature, count beats accurately while performing or listening, group notes and beats correctly into measures, sight-sing a short melody $\frac{3}{4}$ in time, and express rhythm confidently using voice, body percussion, or musical instruments.



b. Teaching and learning resources

- Musical staves
- Different musical equipment,
- Pictures showing different musical instruments,
- Audio and video sets.

c. Teaching and learning activities

In this lesson **"$\frac{3}{4}$ time signature"**, the teacher will help the pupils to remember time signatures through brainstorming, questions and answers, manipulation, group discussion and other techniques. After, s/he introduces the new lesson related to $\frac{3}{4}$ time signature.

This lesson has three periods and will contain the following activities:

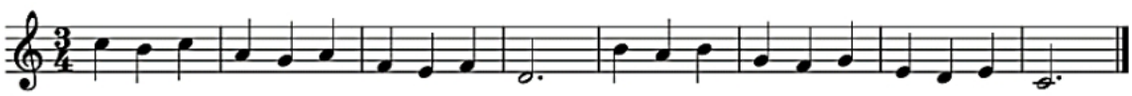
- The teacher guides the pupils to sing the notes, respecting the $\frac{3}{4}$ time signature, by clapping their hands.
- Remember that one quarter note equals one beat or one clap. One half note equals two beats or two claps.
- Tell the pupils that a dot added on a half note is a third clap, which makes a doted half note equal to three claps.



After sol-fa singing in time signature, the teacher guides the pupils to sing the song silent night.

Learning activity 1.5

Observe the following melody and tell the number of beats that are in each measure/bar:



Answer: there are **3 beats** in a measure/bar of the given staff.

Application activity 1.3

1. How many beats are there in a bar of time signature?

   Answer: *There are three beats in a bar of time signature*

2. Read the following melodies respecting ¾-time signature



   Guidance: the teacher makes sure that all the pupils are able to sing the notes correctly respecting pitch and the time signature.

3. Fill in missing notes to complete the given time signature



   Answer:



Learning activity 1.4

Observe the following melody and tell the number of beats that are in each bar:



Answer: There are **four beats** in a bar of the given staff.

Lesson 4: $\frac{4}{4}$ Time signature

a. Learning objectives

To define a time signature in written music, recognize and interpret the $\frac{4}{4}$ time signature, count beats accurately while performing or listening, group notes and beats correctly into measures, sight-sing a short melody in $\frac{4}{4}$ time, and express rhythm confidently using voice, body percussion, or musical instruments.



b. Teaching and learning resources

- Musical staves
- Different musical equipment,
- Pictures showing different musical instruments,
- Audio and video sets.

c. Teaching and learning activities

In this lesson **"$\frac{4}{4}$_time signature"**, the teacher will help the pupils to remember $\frac{2}{4}$ and $\frac{3}{4}$ time signatures through brainstorming, questions and answers, manipulation, group discussion and other techniques. After, s/he introduces the new lesson related to $\frac{4}{4}$ time signature.

- This lesson has three periods and will contain the following activities:
- The teacher guides the pupils to sing the notes, respecting the time signature, by clapping their hands.
- Remember that one quarter note equals one beat or on clap. One half note equals two beats or two claps. A whole note equals four beats or four claps.





After sol-fa singing in time signature, the teacher guides the pupils to sing the song Rwanda nziza.

Application activity 1.4

1. How many beats are there in a bar of time signature?

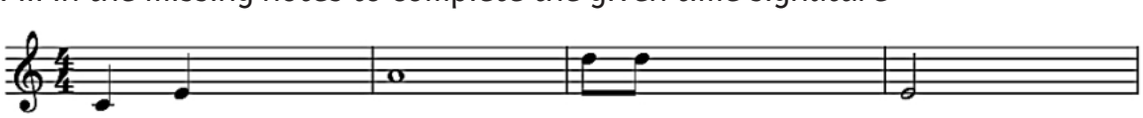
   Answer: There are 4 beats in a bar of time signature

2. Read the following melodies respecting the time signature



   Guidance: The teacher makes sure that all the pupils are able to read them correctly; respecting the time signature and the pitch of each note.

3. Fill in the missing notes to complete the given time signature



   Answer:



1.6 End of unit *a*ssessment

- Knowledge

1. How many beats are there in the following time signatures?

   a. $\frac{2}{4}$

   b. $\frac{3}{4}$

   c. $\frac{4}{4}$

Answer:

2. How many beats are there in the following time signatures?

   a. There are **2 beats** in $\frac{2}{4}$time signature

   b. There are **3 beats** in $\frac{3}{4}$ time signature

   c. There are **4 beats** in $\frac{4}{4}$ time signature

3. Fill in the time signature:



Answer:



- Skills

4. Sing the following melodies while clapping your hands.





Guidance: The teacher makes sure that all the pupils are able to read the notes correctly clapping their hands respecting the beats.

- Attitudes and Values

5. What behaviors do you have to adopt to sing well individually and in group with other pupils?

   Guidance: The teacher guides the pupils to give and explain the behaviors/ values they must adopt. In their answer they can mention and explain values such as cooperation, respect, hard work, determination etc.

1.7 Additional activities

This part contains remedial activities, consolidation activities and extended activities.

1.7.1 Remedial activities

Multiple Choice Questions

1. Which of the following is a simple time signature?

   a. $\frac{6}{8}$

   b. $\frac{9}{8}$

   c. $\frac{4}{4}$

   d. $\frac{12}{8}$

   Answer: c

2. In a time signature, how many beats are there in a measure?

   a. 2

   b. 3

   c. 4

   d. 6

   Answer: *b. 3*

3. Which note gets one beat in a time signature?

a. Whole note
b. Half note
c. Quarter note
d. Eighth note

Answer: c. Quarter note

4. Which of the following time signatures is not simple?
   a. $\frac{2}{4}$
   b. $\frac{3}{4}$
   c. $\frac{4}{4}$
   d. $\frac{6}{8}$

   Answer: *D.* $\frac{6}{8}$

5. What does the top number of a time signature indicate?
   a. Type of note that gets one beat
   b. Number of beats per measure
   c. Number of notes in a bar
   d. Tempo of the piece

   Answer: b. Number of beats per measure

6. True or False Questions
   a. A $\frac{2}{4}$ time signature means there are 2 quarter note beats per measure.

      Answer: True

   b. In $\frac{3}{4}$ time, the half note gets one beat.

      Answer: False

   c. $\frac{4}{4}$ is also known as common time.

      Answer: True

   d. Simple time signatures divide each beat into three equal parts.

      Answer: False

   e. The bottom number in a time signature tells you the type of note that **receives one beat.**

      Answer: *True*

1.7.2 Consolidation activities

Question 1:

Create a 4-measure rhythm pattern in $\frac{3}{4}$ time signature using quarter notes, half notes, and eighth notes. Clap and count it aloud, then explain how the time signature helped you structure your rhythm.

Answer 1:

The teacher makes sure that the pupils mention that $\frac{3}{4}$ means three beats per measure, and they use rhythms that fit into three beats. Correct clapping and counting (1-2-3) show performance understanding.

Question 2:

Compare $\frac{2}{4}$ and $\frac{3}{4}$ time signatures. How do they affect the feel and movement of a song? Give examples of music or dance styles that commonly use the mentioned time signatures.

Answer 2:

$\frac{2}{4}$ has two quarter-note beats per measure and often feels "march-like" (e.g., marching band, military rhythm).

$\frac{3}{4}$ has three quarter-note beats per measure and often feels like a walkover or dance in triple meter.

1.7.3 Extended activities

Question 1:

Your music group is clapping a rhythm in $\frac{4}{4}$ time, but one member is clapping in $\frac{3}{4}$.

What could be the problem? How would you help him/her to clap respecting the rhythm performed by the group.

Possible answer:

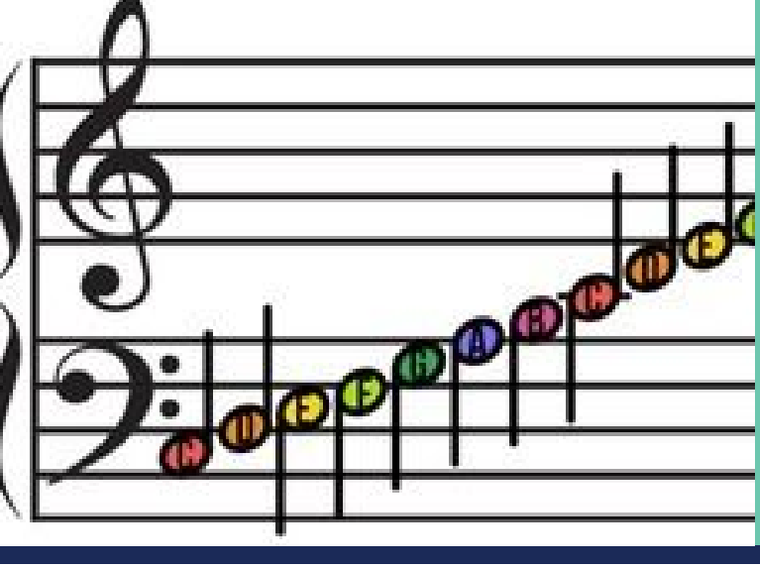
The pupils might be miscounting the beats or not listening carefully. Count the beats aloud together, clap slowly, and practice with a metronome or teacher guidance. Encourage listening and group coordination.

Question 2:

Compose a four-bar melody in the $\frac{2}{4}$ time signature.

The melody must clearly reflect the structure. If lyrics are added, the syllables should match the beats.

The teacher will check if each pupil has made correctly the given exercise.



Unit 2

BASS STAFF AND GRAND STAFF

2.1 Key unit competence

At the end of this unit, each pupil will be able to write and read notes on the grand staff.

Learning objectives

Knowledge	Skills	Attitudes and Values
Understand the structure and purpose of the **bass staff** and the **grand staff**.	Read and write musical notes accurately on both the bass and grand staff.	• Show interest in reading and performing music using both bass and treble clefs • Be attentive and focused when learning to read two-staff music.
Identify the notes on the bass staff (lines: G, B, D, F, A; spaces: A, C, E, G).	Match notes on the bass staff with corresponding pitches on instruments or the keyboard.	• Demonstrate patience and determination while developing reading fluency across the grand staff. • Appreciate the importance of reading full musical scores (melody and accompaniment).
Know how the treble and bass staffs combine to form the grand staff with middle C as a reference point.	Use both clefs when performing simple pieces written in grand staff notation.	• Respect others' efforts in group performance involving different parts.
Recognize the **bass clef ( )** symbol and its placement	Play or sing simple two-staff melodies (right and left hand, or treble and bass clef lines).	• Value structured music learning and the discipline required for musical literacy.

2.2 Prerequisites

- Recognize treble and bass clefs.
- Differentiate note values and rhythm.
- Understand that notes placed higher on the staff represent higher pitches, while those placed lower represent lower pitches.
- Understand the structure of the musical staff (5 lines, 4 spaces).

2.3 Introductory activity and guidance

Introductory activity 2

Read the following scenario and answer the question that follows it.

Once upon a time, in the Land of Music, there were two villages — one high in the mountains called Treble Town, and one low in the valley called Bass Bay. Treble Town was full of high, sweet sounds, birds, flutes, and singing voices. Bass Bay had deep, rich sounds, drums, tubas, and the roar of the sea. But there was a problem. Treble Town and Bass Bay couldn't share music with each other. They had no way to connect. Until one day, a group of young musicians built a bridge called the Grand Staff! This special bridge joined the two villages so both high and low notes could be played together in perfect harmony.

Why do you think musicians need both treble and bass clefs?

Guidance on the introductory activity

In the introductory activity, the teacher will guide the pupils to identify the relationship between the treble and bass staves basing on the scenario. This will be through presenting the scenario, brainstorming, and warm up, listening to music, displaying a picture, watching a video clip or presentation. The teacher will present the scenario and ask pupils to read it individually then loudly. After reading, the teacher will help the pupils understand the message by explaining difficult words. The teacher will also use questioning answer techniques to guide them understand the lesson on bass staff and grand staff. The teacher will guide the pupils to draw staves and draw G and F clefs on them.

Answer to introductory activity 2

Why do you think musicians need both treble and bass staves?

- To represent a wide range of pitches
- The treble staff covers higher-pitched notes
- The bass staff covers lower-pitched notes
- Together, they span the full range of most western instruments, from the lowest to the highest notes.

2.4 Cross cutting issues to be considered

Peace and Values Education

This is addressed through group activities where pupils develop values of patience, respect, cooperation, unity, and appreciation for each another talent. They learn to wait for their turns, listen to others, and work harmoniously.

Gender balance

This is addressed when a teacher forms groups of pupils and mixes boys and girls so that they sing together. The teacher invites pupils to form groups without discrimination and give them the equal opportunities to give answers, views and assistance.

Inclusive education

This is addressed by allowing pupils with different disabilities to do what they are able to do, and provides them special assistance in their groups. During the assessment, the teacher gives them the opportunity to provide answers basing on their abilities and encourage them.

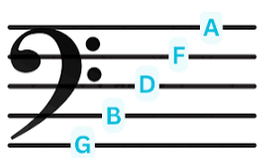
Critical Thinking

This will be addressed by asking pupils to compare different notes basing on their pitches on the staves and think about why some are higher and others lower.

2.5 List of lessons to be taught of unit two

No	Content	General objectives	Number of periods
1	Bass staff	Notate pitches accurately on both the treble and bass staves. Identify the two staves that make up the grand staff: treble staff and bass staff. Locate the Middle C as the central reference point between the two staves. Sight-read/sing musical notes on the grand staff.	3
2	Grand staff		3
3	Assessment		1

Lesson 1: Bass staff



a. Learning objectives

By the end of this lesson, each pupil should be able to

- Identify and describe both the treble and bass staves
- Recognize and name line and space notes on each staff correctly
- Sight-read short musical pieces written on the staves, and
- Demonstrate interest and confidence in reading music using the treble and bass clefs.

b. Teaching and learning resources

- Different teaching materials containing the bass staff and the treble staff
- Pictures showing different musical instruments,
- Audio and video set

c. Teaching and learning activities

In this lesson "BASS STAFF", the teacher will help the pupils identify with writing and reading notes on the treble and bass staves.

Introduction

- The teacher shows the pupils a musical staff containing the treble clef and ask them to describe them (notes). The teacher reminds the pupils that the staff with a treble clef is known as a treble staff.
- The teacher tells them that the treble staff is not the only staff used in music.
- The teacher shows the bass staff and guide them to identify what they see by asking them different questions leading to the new lesson.

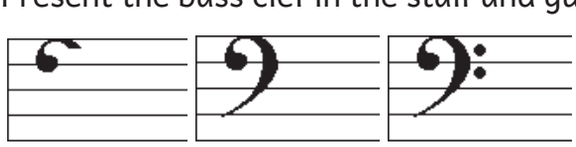
Body of the lesson

The treble clef

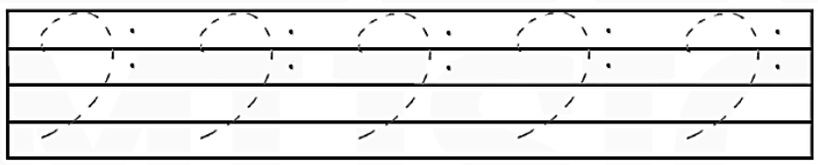
Ask the pupils to draw a treble clef on the musical staff and say its relationship with the G line on the staff.

The bass clef

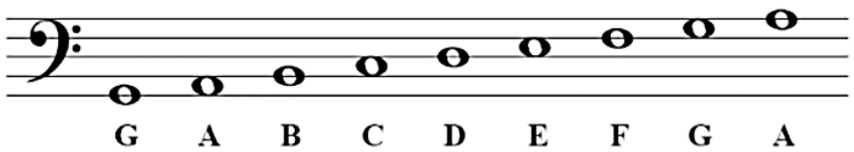
- Present the bass clef in the staff and guide the pupils to draw it step by step



- Guide them to discover the position of F note referring to the dots on the 4th line of the staff.
- Ask the pupils to draw the bass clef in the staff several times to be familiar with it.



- Ask the pupils to add notes and sing them. They must sing using sol-fa notation (do, re....)



Answers for activities on bass staff

Learning activity 2.1

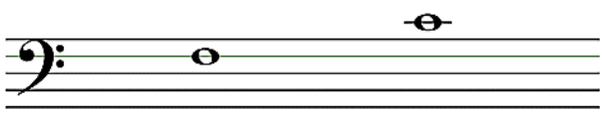
1. Draw a treble staff then write the ascending C scale notes on it.

   Answer:



2. Draw a bass clef and show the position of F note.

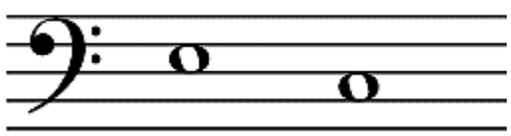
   Answer:



Application activity 2.1

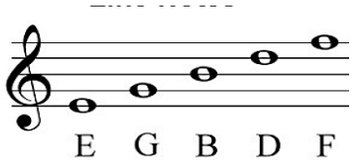
1. Draw a bass staff and place two notes (E and C) on it.

   Answer:



2. What are the notes that are on the lines in the treble staff?

   Answer:

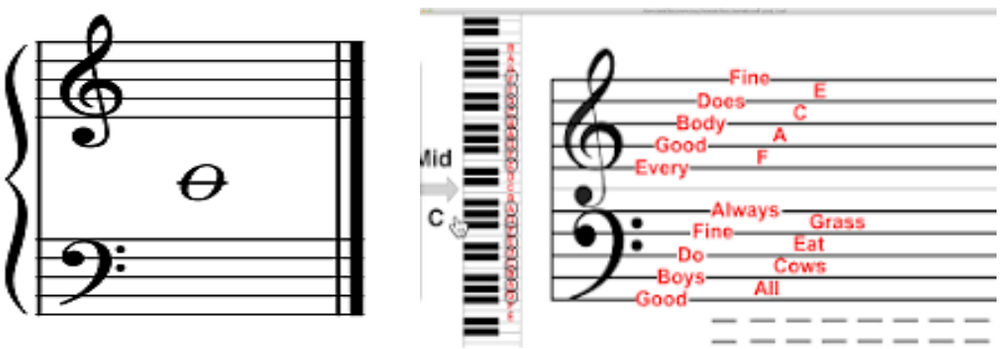


3. What are the notes in spaces in the bass staff?

Answer:



Lesson 2: Grand Staff



a. Learning objectives

To identify the treble and bass staves that form the grand staff, locate Middle C as the central reference point, notate pitches accurately on both staves, sight-read basic pieces written on the grand staff, and appreciate the importance of the grand staff in piano music and other multi-staff compositions.

b. Teaching and learning resources

- Different teaching materials containing the bass staff and the grand staff
- Pictures showing different musical instruments,
- Audio and video sets.

c. Teaching and learning activities

In this lesson "Grand staff", the teacher will help the pupils to identify and write notes on the grand staff through brainstorming, questions and answers, demonstration, group discussion and other techniques.

Introduction

- The teacher shows the pupils a musical staff containing the treble and bass staff and ask them what they see
- The teacher asks the pupils to compare the two staves basing on their position where the treble staff is placed above the bass staff
- The teacher guides them to identify what they see in the illustration by asking them different questions leading to the new lesson.

Body of the lesson

The grand staff

Review **treble clef** and **bass clef** notes separately.

Practice basic **note values** and simple rhythms.

Explain that the grand staff combines the treble and bass staves.

Show a visual chart with both clefs connected by a brace and a vertical line.

Introduce Middle C as the connecting note between the staves.

Use colored lines or magnets to show how Middle C connects the two staves.

Start from Middle C and show how notes go upward on the treble and downward on the bass.

Practice naming notes from Middle C on both staves (treble staff and bass staff).

Introduce line and space names (EGBDF, FACE, GBDFA, ACEG).

Give worksheets for **note identification** on both staves.

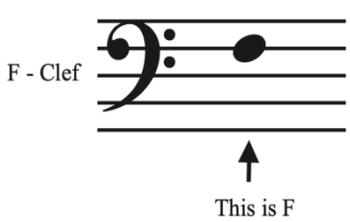
Practice writing notes on a blank grand staff.

Answers for activities

Guidance to leaning activity 2.1

i. Check if the pupils have placed the notes on c scale both on lines and in spaces.

ii. Check if the pupils have placed the note F on the fourth line of the bass staff.



Application activity 2.2

1. Draw a music staff with a bass clef and place two notes: E and C.
2. What are the notes that are on lines in the treble staff?
3. What are the notes in spaces on the bass staff?
4. Sing the notes below while clapping your hands.

Answers to the application activity 2.2

1. Check if the pupils have placed the notes E and C in their right positions.
2. The notes that are on lines in the treble staff are: E,G,B and F
3. The notes that are in spaces on the bass staff are: A, C, E, and G.
4. Check if the pupils sing the notes respecting time signature, beats, and pitches.

Answer to Application activity 2.3

1. What is the note considered as the bridge between the treble and bass staves?

   Answer: **T**he note considered as the bridge between the treble and bass staves is middle **C**

2. Considering the grand staff, which staff is below and which one is above and why?

   Answer: On the Grand staff, The Treble Staff is above while the and Bass Staff is Below. Because the treble staff represents higher pitches, so it is placed on top. The bass staff represents lower pitches, it is placed below. This visual layout follows the natural way we understand pitch: High sounds are "up", and low sounds are "down."

Answer to learning activity 2.2.

What happens if the treble and the bass staves are combined to make one big staff?

Answer:

When the treble and bass staves are combined, they form what is called the grand staff (or great staff). This combination creates a larger staff system that allows musicians to read and perform a wide range of notes.

2.7 End of unit assessment

- Knowledge and skills

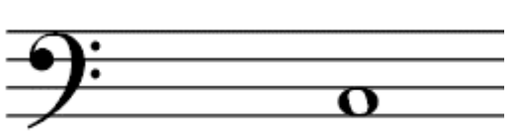
1. Draw a treble clef on a staff and put the notes of the ascending C scale.

   Answer:



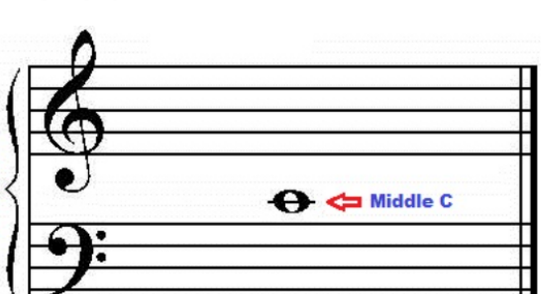
2. Draw a bass staff and indicate the position of C note.

   Answer:



3. Draw a grand staff and show the position of middle C

   Answer:



- Knowledge

4. How are notes positioned on the bass and treble staves of the grand staff?

   Answer:

   On the grand staff, the notes are arranged by pitch according to the clef on each staff. Each staff has five lines and four spaces, and each line or space represents a specific note.

On a treble staff there are **higher-pitched** notes while on the bass staff there are **lower-pitched** notes.

- Skills

5. Sol-fa the following melodies



Check if the pupils sing the notes respecting time signatures, pitches, and clapping correctly respecting beats.

- Attitudes and values

6. Describe four behaviors that are the most important for you to become a good musician?

Guide to the teacher

In their answer, the pupils will give their preferred behaviors/values. Guide them to mention their different values and help them to defend their choices. They may mention values such as, hard work, punctuality, cooperation, respect, determination, etc.

2.7 Additional activities

This part contains remedial activities, consolidation activities and extended activities

2.7.1 Remedial activities

Multiple Choice Questions

1. **What does the treble clef indicate?**
   a. High-pitched notes
   b. Low-pitched notes
   c. Fast tempo
   d. Loud sound

   ✓ **Correct answer:** a
2. **Which clef is also called the G clef?**
   a. Bass clef
   b. Treble clef
   c. Alto clef
   d. Tenor clef

   ✓ **Correct answer:** b
3. **Where is Middle C located on the grand staff?**
   a. On the bottom line of the treble staff
   b. On the top line of the bass staff
   c. On a ledger line between the treble and bass staves
   d. On the third line of the treble staff

   ✓ **Correct answer:** c
4. **Which hand usually plays the bass staff in piano music?**
   a. Right hand
   b. Both hands
   c. Left hand
   d. Feet

   ✓ **Correct answer:** c

5. **How many lines are on each individual staff?**

   a. 3
   b. 5
   c. 7
   d. 6

   ✓ **Correct answer:** b

True or False

6. The grand staff consists of the treble clef and the alto clef.

   ✓ **False** (It consists of the treble and bass clefs)

7. The bass clef is used for notating low-pitched notes.

   ✓ **True**

8. The treble clef is usually played with the left hand.

   ✓ **False** (It is played with the right hand)

9. Middle C is a note that connects the treble and bass staves.

   ✓ **True**

10. The bass clef is also known as the F clef.

    ✓ **True**

Matching

Match the clef or note with its description:

Column A	**Column B**
1. Treble Clef	A. Played with left hand on piano
2. Bass Clef	B. Also called G clef
3. Middle C	C. Found between the two staves
4. Grand Staff	D. Combines treble and bass clefs
5. Bass Clef	E. Also called F clef

Answers:

1 – B

2 – A

3 – C

4 – D

5 – E

2.7.2 Consolidation activities

1. What is the function of a clef in music notation, and how does it help a musician read music?
2. Explain why the treble clef is placed above the bass clef on the grand staff.
3. Describe the role of Middle C in the grand staff and its importance for beginners.
4. In what ways does the grand staff help pianists play music more effectively?
5. What would happen if music only used one clef instead of both treble and bass? How would that affect reading music?

Proposed answers

1. What is the function of a clef in music notation, and how does it help a musician read music?

   Answer: A clef is a symbol placed at the beginning of a staff to show the pitch of the notes. It tells the musician which note belongs to which line or space. For example, the treble clef/G clef shows that the second line from the bottom is G, while the bass clef shows that the fourth line from the bottom is F.

2. Explain why the treble clef is placed above the bass clef in the grand staff.

   Answer: The treble clef is placed above because it represents higher-pitched notes, which are usually played with the right hand. The bass clef is below because it represents lower-pitched notes, played with the left hand. This arrangement matches the way sound is heard—from high to low—and how a piano is laid out.

3. Describe the role of Middle C in the grand staff and its importance for beginners.

   Answer: Middle C is the note that connects the treble and bass staves. It lies on a ledger line between the two staffs. It is often the first note that beginners learn because it serves as a reference point for reading both clefs and helps Pupils transition from one clef to the other.

4. In what ways does the grand staff help pianists play music more effectively?

   Answer: The grand staff allows pianists to read music for both hands at the same time. The treble clef shows notes for the right hand (higher pitches), and the bass clef shows notes for the left hand (lower pitches). This helps pianists perform full melodies, harmonies, and chords efficiently.

5. What would happen if music only used one clef instead of both treble and bass?

   Answer: If only one clef were used, many notes would need to be written with lots of ledger lines, which would make music difficult to read. Musicians would struggle to find the correct pitches quickly, especially on instruments like the piano, which has a wide range.

2.7.3 Extended activities

1. Compare the line and space notes of the treble and bass clefs. How do they differ and why?
2. How can knowing both clefs help a musician play more than one instrument or read full musical scores?
3. Draw and label a grand staff, including the treble clef, bass clef, brace, and Middle C. Then explain each part.
4. Imagine you are teaching a younger pupil how to read the grand staff. What steps would you take to help him/her understand it?
5. Why is it important for pupils who studies music to understand both the treble and bass clefs, even if they only play one instrument?

Proposed answers

1. Compare the line and space notes of the treble and bass clefs. How do they differ, and why?

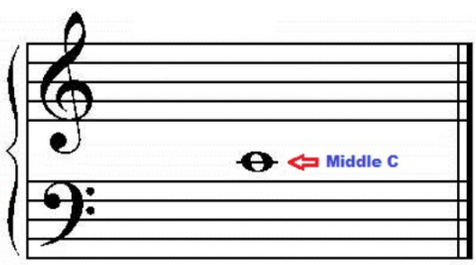
   Answer: In the treble clef, the line notes are E-G-B-D-F, and the spaces are F-A-C-E. In the bass clef, the lines are G-B-D-F-A, and the spaces are A-C-E-G. They differ because each clef is centered around a different note (G for treble, F for bass), and this helps musicians read pitches appropriate for different ranges.

2. How can knowing both clefs help a musician play more than one instrument or read full musical scores?

   Answer: Knowing both clefs allows musicians to read a wider range of notes and play multiple instruments. For example, a pianist needs both, a cellist needs bass, and a violinist needs treble. Also, composers and conductors must read full scores that use many different clefs for different instruments.

3. Draw and label a grand staff, including the treble clef, bass clef, brace, and Middle C. Then explain each part.

   Answer: (pupils draw a grand staff)



- Treble clef: Top staff, represents higher notes.
- Bass clef: Bottom staff, represents lower notes.
- Brace: Curly bracket on the left joining the two staves.
- Middle C: On a ledger line between the two staves, connects the clefs.

These parts help pianists play and read music with both hands.

4. Imagine you are teaching a younger pupil how to read the grand staff. What steps would you take to help him/her understand it?

   Answer: I would start by teaching him/her the treble and bass clefs separately. Then I would introduce Middle C as the bridge between the two. I would use visual aids, games, and keyboard activities to show how each clef matches the hands. Finally, I would have him/her read simple exercises using both clefs.

5. Why is it important for pupils who study music to understand both the treble and bass clefs, even if they only play one instrument?

   Answer: Understanding both clefs gives pupils a full picture of how music works. It helps them become better at reading music, transposing, and understanding other instruments. It also prepares them to play new instruments or read scores in music ensembles.



Unit 3

PIANO PRACTICE

3.1 Key unit competence:

At the end of this unit, each pupil will be able to play simple songs on the keyboard

Learning objectives

Knowledge	Skills	Attitudes and Values
Identify the names of white and black keys on the keyboard. Understand the layout of octaves on the keyboard. Recognize basic musical notation related to keyboard playing (e.g., C major scale, finger numbers).	Demonstrate correct hand position and posture while playing. Play simple melodies using the C major scale with both hands. Coordinate both hands to play short, simple two-hand pieces. Sight-read basic keyboard music.	• Show discipline and patience during individual and group keyboard practice. • Develop confidence and creativity in musical expression. • Respect musical instruments and peers during practice • Demonstrate perseverance in mastering new keyboard skills.

3.2 Prerequisites

- Identify white keys and black keys.
- Know names of lines and spaces in the grand staff.
- Know simple time signatures.
- Place the right hand on C position (starting at Middle C).
- Read short melodic phrases using letter names or notes on the staff.
- Understand note values and rhythm.
- Understand the structure of the grand staff (5 lines, 4 spaces).

3.3 Introductory activity and guidance

Introductory activity 3

One day, a young girl named Teta visited a local cultural center. There, she saw a keyboard with a small sign that said, *"Learn to play, and discover the music in you!"* Teta touched a key, and it made a sweet sound. An old musician nearby smiled and said, "Even the best musicians in Rwanda started with simple songs. Try it, you might be surprised!"

Teta was curious and excited to begin. She sat down, ready to play her first song. **Are you ready to discover the music, too?**

Guidance on the introductory activity

- The teacher will present the scenario and ask the pupils to read it individually and then loudly.
- After reading, the teacher will guide them to understand the message of the passage by helping them to understand difficult words.
- The teacher will also use questions and answers to guide them to identify and understand the lesson of the piano practice.
- The teacher will present the piano keyboard and guide pupils to play basing on their abilities.

Possible answer to the introductory activity

Are you ready to discover the music in you too?

Here the pupils will give various answers. Help them discover that playing music instrument is done gradually and at the end they become skilled musical instrument players.

3.4 Cross cutting issues to be addressed

Peace and Values Education

This is addressed through group activities related to the safety of the piano where pupils develop values of cleanliness, patience, self-reliance, respect, cooperation, unity, and appreciation for one another talent. They learn to wait for their turns, listen to one another and work harmoniously.

Gender balance

This is addressed when a teacher gives equal opportunities, regardless of gender, to participate in the piano keyboard practice. Encouragement is given to both boys and girls to explore music and express themselves confidently.

Inclusive education

This is addressed by allowing pupils with special needs (e.g., physical, visual, or hearing impairments) to get involved in the piano practice and to ensure that they are supported with adapted materials or approaches (e.g., using larger notation, tactile keyboards, or simplified rhythms) to ensure full participation.

Financial Education

It is addressed through allowing pupils to explore the idea of **music as a profession** and discuss how musical skills (like playing keyboard) can be used to **earn a living**, such as performing, teaching, or composing.

Comprehensive Sexuality Education (CSE)

It is addressed in a respectful, age-appropriate way, keyboard practice can foster body awareness, confidence, and respectful relationships. For instance, pupils are taught to respect personal space when playing together.

Genocide Studies and Human Rights

It is addressed by using keyboard practice to play songs that promote healing, unity, and remembrance by playing songs of peace, national unity, or tribute. It also promotes respect and dignity for all.

Standardization Culture

This is addressed where pupils are encouraged to follow **correct procedures** for posture, fingering, and technique, fostering a culture of **discipline, quality, and consistency** in their practice.

3.5 List of lessons to be taught of unit three

No	Content	General objectives	Number of periods
1	Finger numbers	Apply basic finger numbers (1–5)	1
2	Playing C scale with the right hand.	To play scale patterns or short exercises accurately.	3
3	Playing C scale with the left hand.	Demonstrate correct sitting posture and hand positioning while playing the piano.	3
4	Playing simple melodies in C scale.		2
5	Application songs.	Play simple melodies/songs using both hands, starting with one hand and progressing to using two hands.	6
7	Assessment		1

Lesson 1: Finger numbers

a. Learning objectives

To identify and apply correct finger numbers (1–5) for both hands to play basic piano pieces accurately, smoothly, and with proper technique.

b. Teaching and learning resources

- Different teaching materials including musical staves.
- Pictures showing different hands and musical instruments especially the piano keyboard.
- Audio and video sets.

c. Teaching and learning activities

In this lesson "**Finger numbers**", the teacher will help pupils to identify the correct finger numbers (1 to 5) for both right and left hands through manipulation, questions and answers, demonstration, group discussions and other techniques.

Introduction

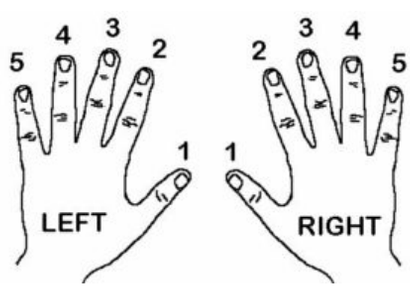
- The teacher asks the pupils to raise their hand and count their fingers.
- The teacher asks them to tell the number and names of fingers their fingers
- The teacher shows the picture of hands positioned on the keyboard and asks them different questions leading to the new lesson.

Body of the lesson

Finger numbers

Explain the concept of finger numbers (1–5) for both hands (**Thumb = 1, Index finger = 2, Middle finger = 3, Ring finger = 4 and little finger/Pinky = 5**)

Show them hand diagrams or finger number charts.



- Ask the pupils to hold up each finger and tell its number aloud.
- Practice wiggling or tapping each finger when its number is called out.
- Use finger games like "show me the finger 3" or "which is finger 5 on your left hand?"
- Guide the pupils to place their right hand on Middle C position (C-D-E-F-G) with finger 1 (thumb) on C.



- Do the same for the left hand, placing finger 5 (pinky) on C.

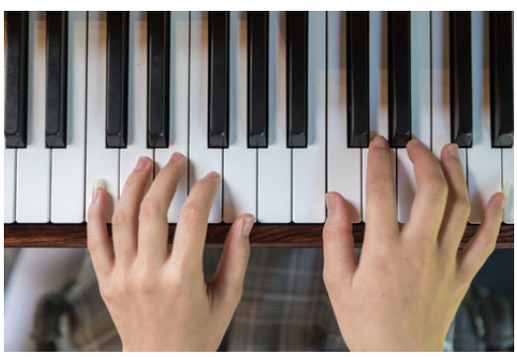


- Let the pupils simple pieces where finger numbers are written above or below the notes.





- Help them match finger numbers to the correct keys.



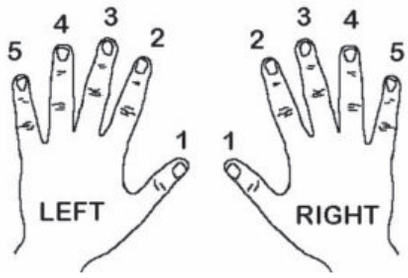
- Practice sight-playing short exercises with finger numbers

Answers for activities

Learning activity 3.1

Observe your hands and tell how many fingers you have on each hand? Give a number to each finger.

Proposed answer:



Application activity 3.1

1. What are the number of fingers on the right hand?

   Answer:



Right Hand

2. Identify the finger numbers on the left hand

   Answer:



Left Hand

Lesson 2: Playing C scale with the right hand

a. Learning objectives

To play the C major scale ascending with the right hand using correct finger numbers, hand position, and smooth legato technique.

b. Teaching and learning resources

- Different musical teaching materials including piano keyboards.
- Pictures showing different hands and musical instruments especially the piano keyboard.
- Piano
- Audio and video sets.

c. Teaching and learning activities

In this lesson "**Playing the keyboard with the right hand**", the teacher will help the pupils to identify the correct finger numbers (1 to 5) and finger transitions for the right hand through manipulation, questions and answers, demonstration, group discussion and other techniques.

Introduction

- Begin with a short discussion: "Have you ever used your right hand to play any instrument?"
- Show a simple video or demonstration of someone playing the keyboard with the right hand.
- The teacher shows a picture of hands positioned on the keyboard and asks them different questions leading to the new lesson.

Body of the lesson

Playing the keyboard with the right hand

Guide the pupils to position fingers on the keyboard and how the transitions are done

Start with the thumb (finger 1), the index (Finger 2), middle finger (Finger 3), then restart from the thumb (finger 1), then the index (Finger 2), middle finger (Finger 3), the ring finger (Finger 4) and the pinky (Finger 5) following the finger pattern.

Start with exercises like: "C-D-E-F-G, G-F-E-D-C" using fingers 1–5 and back.



Let the pupils practice individually or in pairs.

Move around to give feedback on: Fingering, Hand position and Rhythm accuracy.

Teach the descending pattern

Start with the Pinky (Finger 5) then the ring finger (Finger 4), middle finger (Finger 3), the index (Finger 2), the thumb (Finger 1), then continue from middle finger (Finger 3), the index (Finger 2) and the thumb (Finger 1) following the finger pattern.



Then, show them how fingers are transitioned when they go beyond five.

d. Assessment

- Ask the pupils to use the right hand while playing the ascending and descending order.
- Ask them to match fingers with correct keys on the keyboard.
- Ensure that they use proper transition while playing F note in ascending and E note in descending order.

Answers for activities

Learning activity 3.2

Observe this piano keyboard and explain how you can use your right hand to play it.



Proposed Answer:

Show the pupils that each finger touches one note. Finger numbered 1 presses C, finger numbered 2 press D etc.

Application activity 3.2

1. What happens when transitioning to the note F in ascending order?

   Answer: The **thumb (finger 1)** must **tuck under** the hand after finger 3 (middle finger) plays E. This is called the **"thumb-under technique",** which allows you to continue playing up the scale smoothly.

2. What is done to avoid hitting the note F during descending?

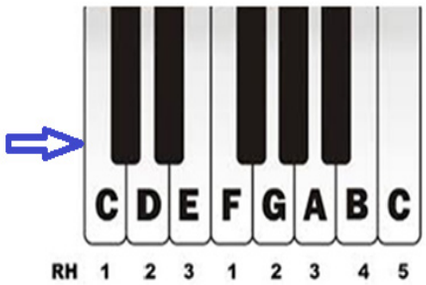
   Answer: To avoid hitting the note F during descending, after playing F with thumb (finger 1), **cross finger 3 over** to play **E.**

3. Draw a keyboard and indicate the keys and the fingers that are used to play them with the right hand.

   Answer:



You can simply ask them to draw it and indicate the following:



Lesson 3: Playing C scale with the left hand

a. Learning objectives

To play the C major scale with the left hand using correct finger numbers, hand position, and smooth legato technique.

b. Teaching and learning resources

- Different musical teaching and learning materials including musical keyboards.
- Pictures showing different hands and musical instruments especially the piano keyboard.
- Audio and video sets.

c. Teaching and learning activities

In this lesson **"Playing the keyboard with the left hand"**, the teacher will help the pupils to identify the correct finger numbers (1 to 5) and finger transitions for the left hand through manipulation, questions and answers, demonstration, group discussion and other techniques.

Introduction

- Begin with a short discussion: "Have you ever used your left hand to play any instrument?"
- Show a simple video or demonstration of someone playing the keyboard with the left hand.
- The teacher shows the picture of hands positioned on the keyboard and asks them different questions leading to the new lesson.

Body of the lesson

Playing the keyboard with the left hand

Guide the pupils to position fingers on the keyboard and how the transitions are done during ascending C scale.

Start with the Pinky (finger 5) then the ring finger (Finger 4), middle finger (Finger 3), the index (Finger 2), and the thumb (Finger 1) then then continue from middle finger (Finger 3), the index (Finger 2) and the thumb (Finger 1) following the finger pattern.

Start with exercises like: “C-D-E-F-G, G-F-E-D-C” using fingers 1–5 and back.



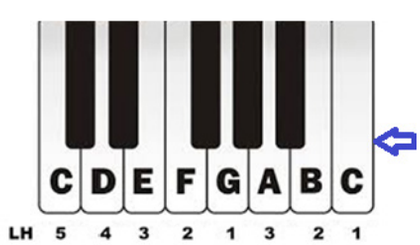
Let the pupils practice individually or in pairs.

Move around to give feedback on: Fingering, Hand position and Rhythm accuracy.

Teach the descending pattern

Start with the thumb (finger 1), then the index (Finger 2), middle finger (Finger 3), the thumb (finger 1), the index (Finger 2), middle finger (Finger 3), the ring finger (Finger 4) and the Pinky (finger 5).

Finger Pattern: 1-2-3-1-2-3-4-5.



Then, show how fingers are transitioned when they go beyond five.

d. Assessment

- Ask the pupils to use the left hand while playing the ascending and descending order.
- Ask them to match fingers with correct keys on the piano keyboard.
- Ensure that they use proper translation while playing A note in ascending and G note in descending order.

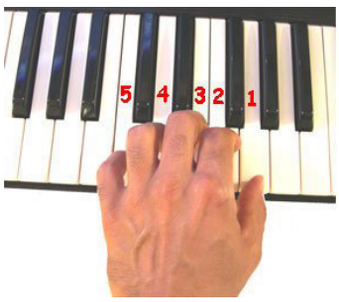
Answers for activities

Learning activity 3.3.

Observe this piano keyboard below and explain how you can use your left hand to play it.



Proposed Answer:



Application activity 3.3

1. What happens when transitioning to the A note in ascending order?

   Answer:

   The hand shifts slightly to the right to allow finger 3 to reach **A** comfortably. This is part of the smooth **scale fingering pattern**: **1 (C) – 2 (D) – 3 (E) – 1 (F) – 2 (G) – 3 (A) – 4 (B) – 5 (C)**

2. What is done to avoid hitting the A note during descending when using the left hand?

   Answer:

   - Finger 3 plays the A note.
   - It fits naturally in the descending pattern.
   - No special finger crossing or repositioning is needed at this point.
   - The hand stays relaxed, ready for finger 2 on G and thumb (1) on F.

3. Draw a keyboard and indicate the keys and the fingers that are used to play them with the left hand.

   Answer:



You can simply ask them to draw it and indicate the following:



Lesson 4: Play simple melodies in C scale

a. Learning objectives

To read simple music and play C scale melodies accurately using correct fingering and hand coordination, with confidence and focus.

b. Teaching and learning resources

- Different musical teaching and learning materials including musical keyboards
- Pictures showing different hands and musical instruments especially the piano keyboard.
- Audio and video sets.

c. Teaching and learning activities

In this lesson **"Playing simple melodies in C scale"**, the teacher will help pupils to play different short melodies through manipulation, questions and answers, demonstration, group discussion and other techniques.

Introduction

- Revise the C major scale (C–D–E–F–G–A–B–C) on the keyboard.
- Practice ascending and descending the scale with both hands separately.
- Show a simple video or demonstration of someone playing melodies on the keyboard.
- Review finger numbers (1–5) for both left and right hands.
- Practice placing fingers on the correct keys for the C scale (e.g., thumb (1) on C).
- The teacher shows the picture of a person playing the keyboard and asks them different questions leading to the new lesson.

Body of the lesson

Playing simple melodies on the keyboard

- Use hand diagrams or finger exercises if needed.
- Play it slowly for the pupils, highlighting which fingers and notes are used.
- Teach the melody one phrase at a time (2–4 notes per part).
- Ask the pupils to echo-play each phrase after you.
- Start with the right hand only, using correct fingerings.
- Remind the pupils to play slowly and carefully, not rushing.
- Correct mistakes gently and repeat tricky parts until smooth.
- Once each phrase is learned, begin linking them together.
- Practice the whole melody to reinforce rhythm and smooth transitions.

- Let the pupils repeat the melody a few times to build confidence.

Practice 1:



Practice 2:



Practice 3:



Practice 4:



d. Assessment

- Invite the pupils to perform for peers to build motivation.
- Ensure that they all play a melody.

Answers for activities

Learning activity 3.4

Play the following melody respecting the fingers and their relative keys:



Proposed answer: Ensure that the pupils tried to play the melody.

Application activity 3.4

Observe the following melody and play it using the right and the left hand.



Proposed answer: Ensure that all the pupils play the melody using the right and the left hand.

Lesson 5: Application songs

a. Learning objectives

To read simple music and confidently play short application songs in the C scale with correct fingering, hand coordination, and focus.

b. Teaching and learning resources

- Different musical materials including musical keyboards.
- Pictures showing different hands and musical instruments especially the piano keyboard.
- Audio and video equipment.

c. Teaching and learning activities

In this lesson **"Application songs"**, the teacher will help the pupils to play and sing different simple songs such as: A la Claire fontaine, Akanyamanza keza, Dore akazuba keza, Twinkle twinkle, Happy birthday and Jingle bells through manipulation, questions and answers, demonstration, group discussion and other techniques.

Introduction

- Revise the C major scale (C–D–E–F–G–A–B–C) on the keyboard.
- Practice both the ascending and the descending order in C scale with both hands separately.
- Show a simple video or demonstration of someone playing melodies on the keyboard.
- The teacher shows the picture of a person playing the keyboard and asks them different questions leading to the new lesson.

Body of the lesson

Playing simple songs on the keyboard

- Guide the pupils to read and sing a song to be learnt.
- Play it slowly for the pupils, highlighting which fingers and notes are used.
- Teach how the song is played one phrase at a time (2–4 notes per part).



- Ask the pupils to echo-play each phrase after you.
- Start with the right hand only, using correct fingerings.

- Remind the pupils to play slowly and carefully, not rushing.
- Correct mistakes gently and repeat tricky parts until smooth.
- Once each phrase is learned, begin linking them together.
- Practice the whole melody in order, reinforcing rhythm and smooth transitions.
- Let pupils play the song several times.
- Let the Pupils repeat the song by playing and singing.



There are other songs that you can teach. Use the time you have and use each period for one song. Other songs will follow the same methodological steps. Those are:

1. A la Claire fontaine

[verse 1]

À la claire fontaine
M'en allant promener,
J'ai trouvé l'eau si belle,
Que je m'y suis baignée.

[Verse 2]

Sous les feuilles d'un chêne
Je me suis fait sécher,
Sur la plus haute branche,
Un rossignol chantait.

[Chorus]

Il y a longtemps que je t'aime,
Jamais je ne t'oublierai.

[Verse 3]

Chante, rossignol, chante,
Toi qui as le cœur gai,
Tu as le cœur à rire,
Moi, je l'ai à pleurer.

[Verse 4]

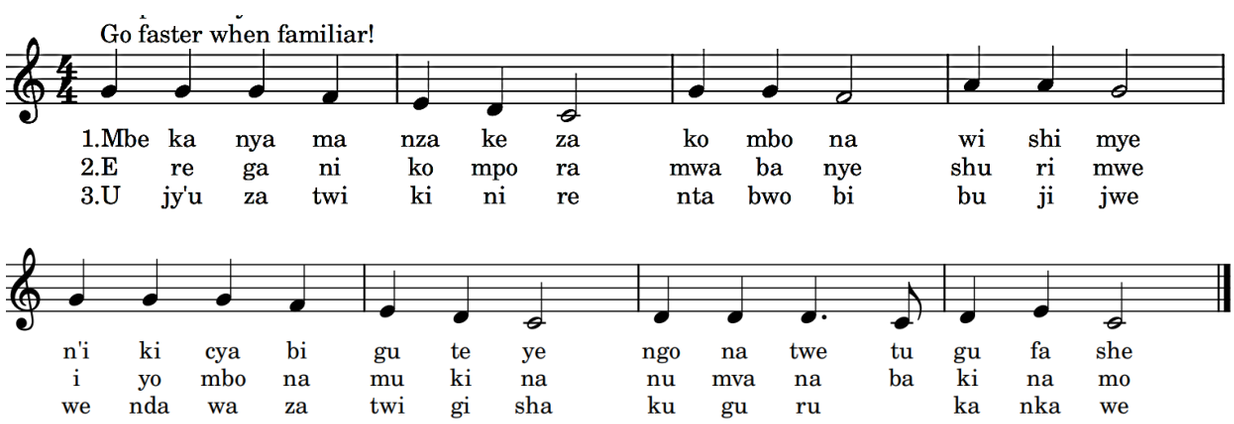
J'ai perdu mon ami
Sans l'avoir mérité,
Pour un bouquet de roses,
Que je lui refusai.

[Verse 5]

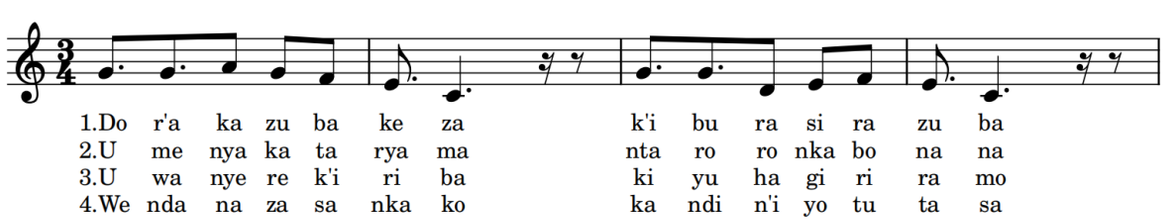
Je voudrais que la rose
Fût encore au rosier,
Et que mon doux ami
Fût encore à m'aimer.



2. Akanyamanza keza



3. Dore akazuba keza





4. Twinkle Little Star

[Verse 1]

Twinkle, twinkle, little star, how I wonder what you are.

Up above the world so high, like a diamond in the sky.

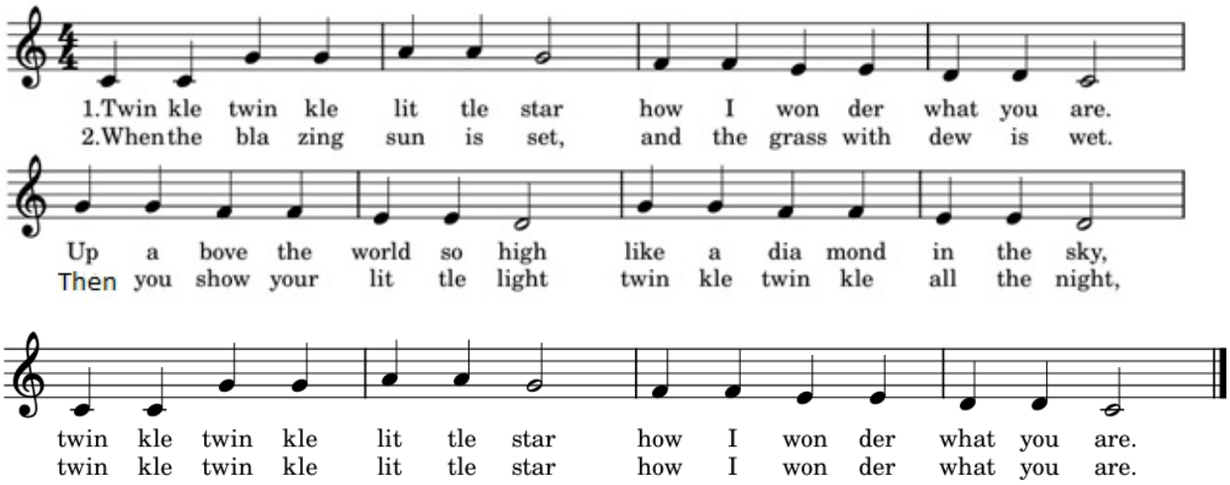
Twinkle, twinkle, little star, how I wonder what you are.

[Verse 2]

When the blazing sun is set and the grass with dew is wet.

Then you show your little light, twinkle, twinkle all the night.

Twinkle, twinkle little star, how I wonder what you are.



5. Happy Birthday

[Verse 1]

We are here for you,

On this special day,

Sending love and joy,

In every way.

[Chorus]

Happy Birthday, happy Birthday!

Happy Birthday, to you!

[Verse 2]

May your dreams come true,
With the rising sun,
May your heart stay bright,
With joy and fun.

(Chorus again)

[Verse 3]

Let the candles shine,
With a wish so true,
We are cheering loud,
Just for you!

(Chorus again)



6. Jingle Bells

[Chorus]

Jingle bells, jingle bells
Jingle all the way
Oh, what fun it is to ride
In a one-horse open sleigh, hey!
Jingle bells, jingle bells
Jingle all the way
Oh, what fun it is to ride
In a one-horse open sleigh

[Verse 1]

Dashing through the snow
In a one-horse open sleigh
O'er the fields we go
Laughing all the way
Bells on bobtail's ring
Making spirits bright
What fun it is to ride and sing
A sleighing song tonight, oh!





d. Assessment

- Invite the pupils to perform for peers to build motivation.
- Ensure that they all play the learnt song.

Answers for activities

Learning activity 3.5

Using your abilities on the keyboard, sing a song of your choice and play it respecting its melody.

Proposed answer: Ensure that the pupils try to sing and try to play a song of their choice.

Application activity 3.5

1. Observe the following melodies and play them using the right and the left hand.

   Proposed answer: Ensure that all the pupils play the melody using the right and the left hand.





2. Sing a song of your choice and play the piano keyboard to accompany it.

   Proposed answer:

   - Ensure that all the pupils sing and play a song of his/her choice. You can also ask them to sing and play the learnt song.
   - Ensure that all the pupils play the melody using the right and the left hand.

3.6 End of unit assessment 3

- Knowledge and skills

1. Draw a piano keyboard and indicate the keys that are played using the right hand.

   Proposed answer:



- Knowledge

2. Write the numbers on the left and the fingers on the right, then match each number to its corresponding finger.

   Proposed answer:

   Thumb = Finger 1

   Index finger = Finger 2

   Middle finger = Finger 3

   Ring finger = Finger 4

   Little finger = Finger 5

- Skills

3. Play the following melodies using the right hand and the left hand:



Proposed answer: Ensure that all pupils play the melody using the right and the left hand.

4. Sing a song of your choice and play the piano keyboard to accompany it.

   Proposed answer: Ensure that all the pupils sing and play a song of their choice. You can also ask them to sing and play some of the learnt songs.

- Attitudes and values

5. What can you do to maintain the safety of the musical instruments, like the piano?

   Possible answers: The pupils will give various answers such as keeping the instrument clean, touching/pressing the piano keys with caution etc. The teacher will guide them to give examples supporting their answers.

6. What can you do to be a skilled instrument player? Why?

   Answer: Here, the pupils will mention the behavior they have to adopt such as hard work, punctuality, self-reliance, cooperation etc.

3.7 Additional activities

This part contains remedial activities, consolidation activities and extended activities.

3.7.1 Remedial activities

1. **Which hand usually plays the melody on the piano?**
   a. Left hand
   b. Right hand
   c. Both hands
   d. Feet
2. **What is the first note of the C major scale?**
   a. G
   b. C
   c. A
   d. F
3. **What is the correct finger number for the right-hand thumb?**
   a. 2
   b. 5
   c. 1
   d. 4
4. **Singing on pitch means:**
   a. Singing loudly
   b. Singing the correct notes

c. Singing fast

d. Singing in any key

5. **Which of these is important for good singing?**

a. Holding your breath

b. Breathing through your nose only

c. Standing or sitting up straight

d. Only using your throat

Fill in the Blanks:

6. The keys of the piano are arranged in repeating groups of _____ and _____ black keys.
7. The five vowel sounds used in singing are: _____, _____, _____, _____, and _____.
8. Playing the piano and singing at the same time requires good _____ and _____.

True or False:

9. A piano has only white keys.....
10. You should sit with a straight back when playing or singing.....
11. Breathing deeply from the diaphragm helps improve singing.....
12. You can only sing well if you have a piano at home.....

Answers

Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs):

1. Which hand usually plays the melody on the piano?

✓ **b.** Right hand

2. What is the first note of the C major scale?

✓ **b.** C

3. **What is the correct finger number for the right-hand thumb?**

✓ **c.** 1

4. Singing on pitch means:

✓ **b.** Singing the correct notes.

5. Which of these is important for good singing?

✓ **c.** Standing or sitting up straight.

Fill in the Blanks:

6. The keys of the piano are arranged in repeating groups of **two** and **three** black keys.
7. The five vowel sounds used in singing are: **A, E, I, O, U**.
8. Playing the piano and singing at the same time requires good **coordination** and **concentration**.

True or False:

9. A piano has both white and black keys. ✗ **False**
10. Good posture helps with both playing and singing. ✓ **True**
11. Diaphragmatic breathing supports better vocal tone. ✓ **True**
12. You can practice singing anywhere, even without a piano. ✗ **False**

3.7.2 Consolidation activities

1. Why is it important to use correct finger numbers when playing the piano?

   Using correct finger numbers helps you play smoothly and efficiently. It builds good technique, prevents strain, and allows you to move easily from one note to another, especially when playing scales or melodies.

2. How does good posture affect your singing and piano playing?

   Good posture helps you breathe better when singing and keeps your hands and arms relaxed when playing the piano. It supports better control, endurance, and comfort during performance.

3. What challenges do musicians face when trying to sing and play the piano at the same time?

   Some challenges include coordinating both hands while also keeping the voice in tune and in rhythm. It can be difficult to focus on the melody, lyrics, and accompaniment all at once.

4. How can a beginner improve his/her singing pitch and piano skills at the same time?

   By practicing slowly, using a keyboard to match pitch, listening carefully, and working on simple songs that combine both playing and singing. Regular repetition and feedback from a teacher also help.

5. Sing a song learnt and accompany it with piano practice

   Ensure that the pupil plays correctly the keyboard matching the song he/she is singing.

3.7.3 Extended activities

1. What are some good warm-up activities before playing the piano or singing?

   Before playing the piano, it helps to stretch your fingers and wrists and play simple scales. Before singing, breathing exercises, humming, and vocal scales warm up the voice and improve control.

2. Why is practicing slowly important when learning a new piece of music?

   Practicing slowly helps you focus on accuracy, finger placement, and coordination. It builds a strong foundation, making it easier to play faster later without mistakes.

3. What should you do if you make a mistake while playing or singing?

Stay calm and don't stop immediately. Try to continue, if possible, then review the part with mistakes afterward. Making mistakes is part of learning and fixing them helps you improve.

4. How does playing the piano help improve your singing?

   The piano helps with learning pitch, rhythm, and harmony. You can use it to practice singing in tune, follow the melody, and understand how the music is structured.

5. What qualities make someone a good performer in music?

   A good performer is confident, expressive, focused, and well-practiced. They also listen carefully, respect others in group settings, and keep trying even when things are hard.

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